FurFriends · Capstone pilot · Content review

Veterinary review of pet health content

FurFriends is a pet health records app for cat and dog owners in the Philippines. It shows owners first-aid steps, breed care information and reminders, and includes a pilot AI assistant. This pack contains all of that content (173 items), so a licensed veterinarian can check it before the app is tested with the public.

How to review

1. For each numbered item, tick **OK**, **Change** or **Remove**.
2. For **Change**, write the correction on the lines (or mark up the text directly).
3. Pay most attention to part A (emergency steps): anything that could delay getting to a vet or cause harm.
4. Sign the last page. The team will update the app and send you a new pack to confirm.

Reviewer name _____ PRC license no. _____

Clinic / institution _____ Date received _____

Contents: A. Emergency first aid (19 items) · B. Breed guide (29) · C. Reminders and record-keeping (2) · D. AI assistant (40) · E. Researched answers (83)

A. Emergency first aid

Shown on the Emergency page. Owners use these steps while getting to a vet, so check that nothing could delay care or cause harm.

A1 "Go to a vet now if you see"

- Struggling to breathe, or pale, blue or grey gums
- Collapse, can't stand, or won't wake up properly
- A seizure lasting over 5 minutes, or more than one in a day
- Swollen, tight belly with retching but nothing coming up
- Straining to pee with little or nothing coming out (especially male cats)
- Ate or touched something poisonous, even if they seem fine
- Bleeding that won't stop after 5 minutes of firm pressure
- Hit by a vehicle or fell from a height
- Heavy panting, drooling and weakness on a hot day
- Any eye injury, or an eye bulging out of its socket

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A2 Normal values

Temperature	38.0–39.2 °C (rectal)
Breathing at rest	Under 30 breaths a minute (count while asleep)
Gums	Moist and pink; color returns within 2 seconds after a press
Heart rate	Dogs 60–140 (small dogs higher) · Cats 140–220 per minute

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A3 Pet first-aid kit

- Your vet's number and the nearest 24-hour animal hospital
- Gauze pads, rolled gauze and self-stick bandage wrap
- Blunt-tip scissors, tweezers and a tick remover
- Sterile saline for rinsing eyes and wounds
- Digital thermometer and petroleum jelly
- Disposable gloves and clean towels
- A soft muzzle (or a strip of cloth) and a cone collar
- Instant cold pack
- Needle-free syringe for rinsing or giving water
- A sturdy carrier, or a board or blanket to carry a large dog

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A4 Heatstroke

Go to a vet now | Heat & burns

Overheating can damage organs within minutes. Flat-faced and thick-coated breeds are most at risk.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Heavy panting, or noisy breathing (any panting in a cat is a warning sign)
- Thick drool, bright red or very pale gums
- Vomiting or diarrhea
- Wobbly, weak or confused; collapse or seizures

DON'T

- Ice or ice-cold water. It narrows blood vessels and slows cooling.
- Leaving a wet towel draped over them. It traps heat. Wet the coat and keep air moving instead.
- Waiting to see if they recover on their own.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Move them out of the sun right away, into shade or an air-conditioned room.
2. Wet the coat with cool tap water, especially the belly, armpits, groin and paws, then fan them so the water evaporates.
3. Offer small sips of cool water if they're alert. Don't force them to drink.
4. Keep cooling for 10–15 minutes, then go to the vet with the car's air-con on, even if they seem better. Damage can show up hours later.
5. If you have a rectal thermometer, stop active cooling at about 39.5 °C so they don't get too cold.

> Never leave a pet in a parked car, even with the windows open. Walk dogs early in the morning or after sunset, and keep water and shade available all day.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A5 Poisoning

Go to a vet now | Poisoning

Many everyday foods, medicines and plants are toxic. Act fast, even if your pet seems fine. Signs can take hours or days.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Vomiting, drooling or diarrhea
- Shaking, twitching or seizures
- Wobbly, unusually sleepy or overexcited
- Pale gums, bleeding or bruising (rat poison)
- Trouble breathing

DON'T

- Making your pet vomit unless a vet tells you to. It's dangerous with some poisons and if your pet is drowsy.
- Home remedies like salt, milk, oil or hydrogen peroxide.
- Giving any human medicine.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Move your pet away from the source and remove anything left in their mouth, if it's safe to do so.
2. Note what they ate, about how much, and when. Bring the packaging, label or a piece of the plant.
3. Call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now and tell them you're on your way.
4. If it's on their skin or fur (for example a flea product), wash with mild dish soap and lukewarm water, then rinse well.

COMMON POISONS

- Chocolate, coffee and energy drinks
- Grapes and raisins
- Onions, garlic and chives
- Xylitol: sugar-free gum, candy and some peanut butters
- Human painkillers. Paracetamol is deadly to cats; ibuprofen harms both cats and dogs.
- Rat and mouse poison, insect sprays and pesticides
- Lilies (cats). Even pollen or the vase water can cause kidney failure.
- Dog flea and tick products on cats (permethrin)
- Alcohol, cleaning products and antifreeze

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A6 Toad poisoning

Go to a vet now | Poisoning

Cane toads, the large brown toads that come out after rain, release a poison when a dog or cat bites or licks them.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Sudden heavy drooling or foaming at the mouth
- Pawing at the mouth, shaking the head
- Bright red gums
- Vomiting, wobbliness, a racing heartbeat, seizures

DON'T

- Spraying water down the throat. It can go into the lungs.
- Making them vomit.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Rinse the mouth straight away. Point the head down and run a gentle stream of water across the gums and tongue from the side, so it flows out of the mouth. Keep going for 10 minutes.
2. Wipe the gums and tongue with a damp cloth to remove the sticky poison.
3. Go to the vet now, especially if there's anything more than drooling.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A7 Choking

Go to a vet now | Breathing & choking

Something stuck in the mouth or throat. If your pet is still breathing and coughing, go to the vet. Only step in if they can't breathe.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Pawing at the mouth, gagging or retching
- Panic, struggling to breathe
- Blue or pale gums
- Collapse

DON'T

- Sweeping your fingers blindly. It can push the object deeper.
- Pulling on string, thread or tinsel hanging from the mouth or bottom. It can cut the intestines.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Stay calm and hold them gently but firmly. A choking pet may bite.
2. Open the mouth and look. If you can see the object and get a grip on it, remove it carefully with fingers or tweezers.
3. If you can't remove it and they can't breathe: hold a cat or small dog with their back against your chest and give 5 firm thrusts inward and upward just below the ribs.
4. For a large dog, put your arms around the belly from behind, make a fist just below the ribs and push firmly up and forward 5 times. If they're lying down, push from behind the ribs toward the head.
5. Check the mouth again and repeat. If they collapse and stop breathing, start CPR.
6. Go to the vet even if the object comes out. The throat may be injured.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A8 Trouble breathing

Go to a vet now | Breathing & choking

Breathing problems can come from heart disease, asthma, injury or allergic reactions. They are always urgent.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Open-mouth breathing in a cat
- Neck stretched out, elbows held out, belly heaving
- More than 40 breaths a minute at rest
- Blue, grey or pale gums; noisy breathing

DON'T

- Holding them tightly or covering their face.
- Offering food or water.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Keep them calm and cool, and handle them as little as possible.
2. Loosen or remove a tight collar or harness.
3. Let them pick the position that's comfortable. Carry small pets in an open carrier.
4. Go to the vet now, with the car's air-con on.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A9 Bleeding & wounds

Go to a vet now | Injuries & wounds

Most bleeding stops with firm, steady pressure. Bite wounds can look small but often get infected.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Bleeding that spurts or won't stop
- A deep or gaping wound, or one on the chest or belly
- Puncture wounds from another animal's bite
- Pale gums, weakness (blood loss)

DON'T

- Tourniquets, unless you're trained. They can kill the limb.
- Hydrogen peroxide or alcohol in the wound. They damage tissue.
- Pulling out something stuck in the wound.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. If they're in pain, use a soft muzzle or towel so they don't bite. Skip this if they're vomiting or struggling to breathe.
2. Press firmly on the wound with a clean cloth or gauze for at least 5 minutes. Don't lift it to check.
3. If blood soaks through, add more layers on top. Don't remove the first one.
4. Once it stops, wrap it snugly but not tight. You should fit two fingers under the bandage.
5. Go to the vet for anything deeper than a scrape, all bite wounds, and any bleeding that won't stop.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A10 Hit by a vehicle or fall

Go to a vet now | Injuries & wounds

Internal bleeding and chest injuries may not show at first. Pets that fall from balconies or windows need a vet check too.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Limping, not putting weight on a leg
- Fast breathing, pale gums
- Swelling belly, bleeding from the nose or mouth
- Seems fine but was hit or fell. Still go.

DON'T

- Giving any painkiller.
- Trying to straighten or splint a leg.
- Giving food or water.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Make sure you're safe from traffic first.
2. Approach slowly and speak softly. Hurt animals bite, so use a towel or muzzle unless they're vomiting or struggling to breathe.
3. Move them as little as possible. Slide a large dog onto a board or blanket to use as a stretcher, keeping the back and neck straight. Put small pets in a box or carrier.
4. Press on any bleeding, keep them calm, and go to the vet now.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A11 Seizures

Go to a vet now | Collapse & seizures

Most seizures stop within 2 minutes. Keep your pet safe, time it, and call your vet.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Collapse, stiff or paddling legs
- Jaw chomping, drooling, losing control of pee or poo
- Not responding to you
- Afterwards: confused, wobbly, briefly blind

DON'T

- Putting fingers or anything else in their mouth. Pets can't swallow their tongue.
- Holding them down.
- Giving food, water or medicine until they're fully alert.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Stay calm and note the time it starts.
2. Move furniture and objects away, keep them away from stairs and water, and put a towel under the head. Keep your hands away from the mouth.
3. Dim the lights and keep things quiet. Film it if you can, since it helps the vet.
4. Afterwards, keep them somewhere quiet and cool, and speak softly while they recover.
5. Call your vet after any first seizure. Go now if it lasts over 5 minutes, they have another one, they don't wake up between seizures, or they may have eaten a poison.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A12 Bloat (twisted stomach)

Go to a vet now | Stomach & bladder | Dogs only

The stomach fills with gas and can twist. It can kill within hours and usually needs surgery. Most common in large, deep-chested dogs.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Swollen, tight belly
- Retching or trying to vomit with nothing coming up
- Restless, pacing, can't get comfortable
- Drooling, pale gums, collapse

DON'T

- Waiting to see if it passes.
- Giving food, water or home remedies.
- Trying to make them vomit.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Go to the vet immediately. Call ahead so they can prepare.
2. Keep your dog as calm and still as you can on the way.

> To lower the risk, feed two or three smaller meals a day and rest for an hour before and after meals.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A13 Can't pee (blocked bladder)

Go to a vet now | Stomach & bladder

A blocked bladder, most common in male cats, can be fatal within a day or two. It's often mistaken for constipation.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Straining in the litter box with little or no pee
- Going back to the box again and again
- Crying while trying to pee, or peeing outside the box
- Licking the genitals; vomiting, hiding, low energy

DON'T

- Pressing on the belly or bladder.
- Waiting until the next day.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Go to the vet now. Tell them when you last saw your pet pee normally.
2. Carry them gently in a carrier.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A14 Vomiting & diarrhea

Call your vet | Stomach & bladder

One episode in a bright, adult pet is often minor. Call your vet for advice and watch closely for the warning signs below.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Go now: repeated vomiting, or they can't keep water down
- Go now: blood in the vomit or stool, or black, tarry stool
- Go now: swollen or painful belly, weakness or collapse
- Go now: a puppy or kitten, or an unvaccinated young dog (parvovirus risk)
- Go now: may have swallowed a toy, bone or poison

DON'T

- Human anti-diarrhea or stomach medicines. Some are toxic to cats and some dogs.
- Withholding food from a cat for more than a day. It can cause liver disease.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Call your vet and describe what you've seen. A photo helps.
2. Offer small amounts of water often.
3. If your vet agrees, feed small portions of bland food, like plain boiled chicken and rice for dogs.
4. Keep a sick puppy away from other dogs and disinfect the area. Parvovirus spreads easily.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A15 Burns & electric shock

Go to a vet now | Heat & burns

Chewed electric cords, hot water and chemicals are the usual causes. Electric shock can cause breathing problems hours later.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Red, blistered or raw skin; singed fur
- Burns at the corners of the mouth after chewing a cord
- Coughing or trouble breathing
- Collapse

DON'T

- Touching a pet that's still in contact with electricity.
- Ice, butter, oil or creams on burns.
- Popping blisters.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Electric shock: switch off the power or unplug before you touch them. If you can't, push them away with something dry and wooden, like a broom handle.
2. Check breathing, and start CPR if they aren't breathing and have no heartbeat.
3. Heat burns: run cool water over the area for 10 minutes, then cover with a clean, damp cloth.
4. Chemical burns: wear gloves and rinse with plenty of running water for 15–20 minutes. Stop them licking it.
5. Go to the vet, even if they seem fine.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A16 Snake bite

Go to a vet now | Bites & stings

Venom spreads faster when your pet moves. Keep them still and get to a vet. Signs can be delayed.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- A sudden yelp, swelling, puncture marks
- Bleeding that won't stop
- Drooling, wide pupils, trembling
- Weakness, wobbliness, trouble breathing, collapse

DON'T

- Cutting the wound, sucking out venom, tourniquets or ice.
- Waiting for signs to appear.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Keep yourself safe. Don't try to catch or kill the snake. Take a photo from a distance if it's easy.
2. Keep your pet calm and still, and carry them if you can.
3. Take off the collar if the bite is on the head or neck, because it may swell.
4. Go to the vet now. Call ahead so they can check for antivenom.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A17 Stings & allergic reactions

Call your vet | Bites & stings

Bee, wasp, ant and centipede stings usually cause swelling that settles. A spreading reaction or trouble breathing is an emergency.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Mild: swelling and pain where they were stung, licking the spot
- Go now: the face swells and keeps spreading, or hives all over the body
- Go now: vomiting, diarrhea, pale gums, weakness or collapse
- Go now: trouble breathing, a sting inside the mouth or throat, or many stings

DON'T

- Giving human allergy or cold tablets without a vet's dose. Some contain decongestants that are toxic to pets.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Move away from the insects.
2. If you see a bee stinger, scrape it out sideways with a card. Don't squeeze it.
3. Hold a cold pack wrapped in cloth on the spot for 10 minutes.
4. Watch closely for the next 1–2 hours and call your vet for advice.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A18 Eye injuries

Go to a vet now | Injuries & wounds

Eyes get worse fast. Flat-faced breeds like Shih Tzus and Pugs are prone to eye injuries, and an eye can even pop out.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Squinting, an eye held shut, pawing at it
- Redness, tearing, cloudiness
- Something stuck in the eye
- An eye bulging out of its socket

DON'T

- Removing something stuck in the eye.
- Pushing a bulging eye back in.
- Human eye drops or ointments.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Stop them rubbing it. Use a cone collar or hold their paws.
2. Chemicals: flush the eye with sterile saline or clean, lukewarm water for 10–15 minutes.
3. Eye out of its socket: keep it moist with a clean cloth soaked in saline and go straight away.
4. Go to the vet the same day for any eye injury.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

A19 CPR

Go to a vet now | Collapse & seizures

Only for a pet who is unconscious, not breathing and has no heartbeat. Get someone to drive to the vet while you work.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR

- Doesn't respond when you call or touch them
- No chest movement for 10 seconds
- No heartbeat on the left side of the chest, just behind the elbow

DON'T

- CPR on a pet who is breathing or has a heartbeat. It can hurt them.

WHAT TO DO NOW

1. Lay them on their right side on a firm surface. Put flat-chested breeds like Bulldogs on their back.
2. Cats and small dogs: wrap one hand around the chest just behind the elbows and squeeze. Larger dogs: stack both hands on the widest part of the chest. On their back: press on the breastbone.
3. Push hard and fast: a third to a half of the chest's width, 100–120 times a minute (the beat of "Stayin' Alive"). Let the chest come all the way back up.
4. After 30 compressions, close the mouth, straighten the neck and give 2 quick breaths into the nose, watching the chest rise.
5. Keep going 30 compressions to 2 breaths. Check for breathing and a heartbeat every 2 minutes, and keep going on the way to the vet.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

B. Breed guide

Shown in the Breed guide and on each pet's profile. The app also uses the weight range to tell owners whether their pet is “within the typical range”. Ratings are 1 (low) to 5 (high); “Handles heat” means tolerance of hot, humid weather.

B1 Aspin (Dog)

Also called Asong Pinoy, Mixed Breed

The Philippines' own street-smart dog: alert, loyal and adaptable. Aspins are generally hardy and well suited to the local climate.

Weight	8–20 kg	**Lifespan**	12–16 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Short, single coat

Energy **4/5** · Grooming needs **1/5** · Shedding **2/5** · Handles heat **5/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Tick-borne blood infections (ehrlichia, babesia)
- Mange and other skin parasites
- Parvovirus and distemper if not vaccinated

CARE TIPS

- Year-round tick and flea prevention is the most important care step.
- Keep vaccines up to date, including rabies and leptospirosis.
- Spaying or neutering helps prevent roaming and unwanted litters.

Feeding Two meals a day of a complete dog food for medium dogs. Rice with leftovers isn't a complete diet, and cooked bones can splinter. Keep the waist visible from above.

Exercise Active. Aim for about an hour a day of walks and play, in the cooler morning or evening. Needs a secure fence, as Aspins like to roam.

Grooming Low. Brush weekly with a rubber brush, bathe monthly or when dirty, and check for ticks after every walk.

Behavior Alert, loyal and quick to learn. Often wary of strangers, which makes a good watchdog. Early socialization and treat-based training work well.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B2 Shih Tzu (Dog)

Affectionate lap dog that loves company. Its flat face and long coat need extra care in hot weather.

Weight	4–7.5 kg	**Lifespan**	10–16 yrs	**Size**	Small	**Coat**	Long, double coat

Energy **2/5** · Grooming needs **5/5** · Shedding **2/5** · Handles heat **1/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Breathing problems from the flat face (BOAS)
- Eye injuries, ulcers and dry eye
- Dental disease
- Ear infections and skin allergies

CARE TIPS

- Keep indoors with a fan or air-con on hot days and avoid midday walks.
- Brush daily or keep a short puppy cut, with a groom every 4–6 weeks.
- Wipe the eyes and face daily, and see a vet quickly for any squinting.

Feeding Small-breed food in two or three small meals. Small kibble is easier for the flat face to pick up. Gains weight easily, so keep treats tiny.

Exercise Low. Two short walks of 15–20 minutes plus indoor play. Never exercise in the heat; the flat face makes overheating dangerous.

Grooming High. Brush daily, or keep a short puppy cut with a groom every 4–6 weeks. Wipe the eyes and face daily and brush the teeth often.

Behavior Friendly, affectionate and happiest near people. Can be slow to house-train, so be patient and consistent.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B3 Labrador Retriever (Dog)

Also called Labrador, Lab

Friendly, eager-to-please family dog with lots of energy. Labs love food, so watch their weight.

Weight	25–36 kg	**Lifespan**	11–14 yrs	**Size**	Large	**Coat**	Short, dense double coat

Energy **5/5** · Grooming needs **2/5** · Shedding **4/5** · Handles heat **3/5** · Good with kids **5/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Obesity
- Hip and elbow dysplasia
- Ear infections
- Exercise-induced collapse

CARE TIPS

- Measure meals and keep treats under 10% of daily food.
- Exercise early in the morning or evening, and let them swim if they can.
- Dry the ears after baths and swimming.

Feeding Large-breed food in two measured meals. Labs are very food-driven and gain weight easily, so measure portions and count treats. A slow-feeder bowl helps fast eaters.

Exercise Very high. One to two hours a day of walks, fetch and swimming. A bored Lab chews. Rest in the shade between games on hot days.

Grooming Moderate. Brush weekly, and daily when shedding. Dry the ears well after swimming to prevent infections.

Behavior Friendly, eager to please and great with families. Easy to train with food rewards, but boisterous as a young dog.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B4 Golden Retriever (Dog)

Also called Golden

Gentle, patient and very social. Their thick coat needs regular brushing and they feel the heat.

Weight	25–34 kg	**Lifespan**	10–12 yrs	**Size**	Large	**Coat**	Medium-long, double coat

Energy **4/5** · Grooming needs **3/5** · Shedding **5/5** · Handles heat **2/5** · Good with kids **5/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Hip and elbow dysplasia
- Higher cancer risk than many breeds
- Hot spots and skin allergies in humid weather
- Hypothyroidism

CARE TIPS

- Brush 2–3 times a week. Don't shave the coat; it protects against sun and heat.
- Dry the coat fully after baths to prevent hot spots.
- Have regular senior check-ups and report new lumps early.

Feeding Large-breed food in two measured meals, and large-breed puppy food while growing. Keep lean, as extra weight strains the hips and elbows.

Exercise High. One to two hours a day of walks, retrieving and swimming, in the cool parts of the day.

Grooming Moderate to high. Brush two or three times a week, and daily when shedding. Trim the feathering and check the ears weekly.

Behavior Gentle, patient and very social. Gets on with people and other pets, but doesn't like being left alone for long.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B5 German Shepherd (Dog)

Also called GSD, Alsatian

Intelligent, loyal working dog that needs training, a job to do and plenty of exercise.

Weight	22–40 kg	**Lifespan**	9–13 yrs	**Size**	Large	**Coat**	Medium, double coat

Energy **5/5** · Grooming needs **3/5** · Shedding **5/5** · Handles heat **2/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Hip and elbow dysplasia
- Bloat (twisted stomach)
- Degenerative myelopathy
- Skin and ear allergies

CARE TIPS

- Feed two or three smaller meals a day and rest after eating to lower bloat risk.
- Give daily training or puzzle games as well as walks.
- Brush several times a week; never shave the double coat.

Feeding Large-breed food in two meals, not one big one. Rest for an hour before and after meals to lower the risk of bloat.

Exercise Very high. One to two hours a day, plus training or puzzle games. Mental work matters as much as walks.

Grooming Moderate. Brush two or three times a week, and daily during the heavy sheds twice a year.

Behavior Loyal, intelligent and protective. Needs early socialization and steady training. Often reserved with strangers.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B6 Siberian Husky (Dog)

Also called Husky

Bred for snow, so the tropics are hard on them. Friendly, vocal and a known escape artist.

Weight	16–27 kg	**Lifespan**	12–14 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Thick, double coat

Energy **5/5** · Grooming needs **3/5** · Shedding **5/5** · Handles heat **1/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Heatstroke
- Eye problems (cataracts, progressive retinal atrophy)
- Hypothyroidism

CARE TIPS

- Needs air-con or a cool shaded room on hot days.
- Exercise only at dawn or after sunset, and watch for heavy panting.
- Don't shave the coat; brush out the loose undercoat instead.

Feeding Often eats less than you'd expect for its size. Two measured meals, adjusted to keep a lean, athletic shape.

Exercise Very high, but only in the cool early morning or late evening here. Keep in a cool room or air-con during the day. Walk on a leash; Huskies run off and escape fences.

Grooming Brush two or three times a week, and daily when shedding. Don't shave the double coat; it protects the skin from sun.

Behavior Friendly, playful and independent, so not a guard dog. Howls and "talks". Strong urge to chase cats and small animals.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B7 Pug (Dog)

Charming, comical companion. The flat face makes breathing and staying cool difficult.

Weight	6–8 kg	**Lifespan**	12–15 yrs	**Size**	Small	**Coat**	Short, fine coat

Energy **2/5** · Grooming needs **2/5** · Shedding **4/5** · Handles heat **1/5** · Good with kids **5/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Breathing problems (BOAS)
- Heatstroke
- Eye injuries
- Skin-fold infections
- Obesity

CARE TIPS

- Keep cool and indoors on hot days, and keep walks short and gentle.
- Clean and dry the face wrinkles daily.
- Use a harness instead of a collar, and keep them lean so they breathe easier.

Feeding Small portions in two meals. Pugs overeat easily, and extra weight makes breathing worse. Use treats sparingly.

Exercise Low to moderate. Two short walks of 15–20 minutes, in cool hours only. Stop at the first sign of heavy panting, and use a harness, not a collar.

Grooming Low to moderate. Brush weekly, as Pugs shed a lot. Clean the face wrinkles daily and dry them well.

Behavior Charming, playful and people-focused. Good with children. Snores, and can be stubborn.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B8 Beagle (Dog)

Merry, curious scent hound. Their nose leads them everywhere, including into the trash.

Weight	9–14 kg	**Lifespan**	10–15 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Short, dense coat

Energy **4/5** · Grooming needs **1/5** · Shedding **3/5** · Handles heat **3/5** · Good with kids **5/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Obesity
- Ear infections
- Epilepsy
- Back problems (IVDD)

CARE TIPS

- Keep food and trash out of reach.
- Walk on a leash or in a secure yard, since they follow their nose.
- Check and clean the floppy ears weekly.

Feeding Two measured meals. Beagles will eat anything, so keep food, rubbish and toxic foods out of reach and watch the waistline.

Exercise High. At least an hour a day. Follows its nose, so walk on a leash and keep a secure fence.

Grooming Low. Brush weekly, and check and clean the long ears weekly.

Behavior Friendly, curious and cheerful. Great with children and other dogs. Bays and howls, and is hard to call back off-leash.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B9 Chihuahua (Dog)

Tiny dog with a big personality. Bonds closely with one person.

Weight	1.5–3 kg	**Lifespan**	14–16 yrs	**Size**	Toy	**Coat**	Short or long coat

Energy **3/5** · Grooming needs **1/5** · Shedding **2/5** · Handles heat **3/5** · Good with kids **2/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Dental disease
- Kneecap slipping (luxating patella)
- Low blood sugar in puppies
- Collapsing windpipe

CARE TIPS

- Brush teeth several times a week.
- Use a harness to protect the windpipe.
- Feed puppies small meals often, and watch for weakness or shaking.

Feeding Small-breed food in two or three small meals. Tiny puppies need frequent meals to avoid low blood sugar. Very easy to overfeed.

Exercise Low to moderate. Short walks and indoor play, about 30 minutes a day. Protect from rough play and cold air-con.

Grooming Low. Brush weekly (long coats two or three times). Brush the teeth often, as dental problems are common.

Behavior Bold, loyal and often attached to one person. Can be wary of strangers and snappy if handled roughly, so best with older, gentle children.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

B10 Pomeranian (Dog)

Also called Pom

Bright, lively little dog with a big fluffy coat. Confident and often vocal.

Weight	1.5–3.5 kg	**Lifespan**	12–16 yrs	**Size**	Toy	**Coat**	Fluffy, double coat

Energy **3/5** · Grooming needs **4/5** · Shedding **4/5** · Handles heat **2/5** · Good with kids **3/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Kneecap slipping (luxating patella)
- Collapsing windpipe
- Dental disease
- Coat loss (alopecia X)

CARE TIPS

- Brush 2–3 times a week down to the skin.
- Keep cool on hot days; the coat traps heat.
- Use a harness instead of a collar.

Feeding Small-breed food in two or three small meals. Keep treats tiny.

Exercise Moderate. Two short walks and play, about 30 minutes a day, in cool hours. Use a harness to protect the windpipe.

Grooming High. Brush two or three times a week, right down to the skin. Don't shave the double coat.

Behavior Lively, curious and alert. Barks readily, so start training early. Better with older, gentle children.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

B11 French Bulldog (Dog)

Also called Frenchie

Easygoing, affectionate companion. One of the breeds most at risk from heat because of its flat face.

Weight	8–13 kg	Lifespan	10–12 yrs	Size	Small	Coat	Short, smooth coat

Energy **2/5** · Grooming needs **1/5** · Shedding **2/5** · Handles heat **1/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Breathing problems (BOAS)
- Heatstroke
- Back problems (IVDD)
- Skin-fold infections and allergies

CARE TIPS

- Keep indoors with air-con on hot days and exercise only when it's cool.
- Can't swim well. Supervise around pools.
- Clean the face folds and keep them lean.

Feeding Two measured meals. Gains weight easily, which makes breathing harder. Some have food allergies, so change foods slowly.

Exercise Low. Short walks of 15–20 minutes in cool hours. Overheats quickly; never leave in a car. Can't swim well, so supervise near water.

Grooming Low. Brush weekly, and clean and dry the face folds.

Behavior Playful, affectionate and happy in small homes. Good with children; can be stubborn.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

B12 Poodle (Dog)

Also called Toy Poodle, Miniature Poodle, Standard Poodle

Very clever and easy to train. Comes in toy, miniature and standard sizes; the coat keeps growing.

Weight	2–32 kg	Lifespan	10–18 yrs	Size	Toy to large	Coat	Curly, low-shedding coat

Energy **4/5** · Grooming needs **5/5** · Shedding **1/5** · Handles heat **3/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Dental disease (smaller sizes)
- Kneecap slipping (luxating patella)
- Progressive retinal atrophy
- Bloat and Addison's disease (standard size)

CARE TIPS

- Professional groom every 4–6 weeks; a short clip is cooler.
- Give daily brain games and training.
- Brush the teeth of toy and miniature Poodles often.

Feeding Food sized for the variety (toy, miniature or standard) in two meals. Standards should rest after meals, as they can get bloat.

Exercise Moderate to high. From 30 minutes a day for toys to over an hour for standards, plus training games. Needs mental work.

Grooming High. Brush several times a week and clip every 4–6 weeks. Clean the ears regularly.

Behavior Very intelligent, eager to learn and sociable. Easy to train, but sensitive to harsh handling.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

B13 Dachshund (Dog)

Also called Doxie, Wiener dog

Brave, playful and stubborn. Their long back needs protecting.

Weight	4–14 kg	**Lifespan**	12–16 yrs	**Size**	Small	**Coat**	Smooth, long or wire coat

Energy **3/5** · Grooming needs **2/5** · Shedding **2/5** · Handles heat **3/5** · Good with kids **3/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Back disc disease (IVDD)
- Obesity
- Dental disease

CARE TIPS

- Use ramps and avoid jumping off furniture or using stairs.
- Keep them slim to take strain off the spine.
- Go to the vet right away for back pain, wobbliness or dragging legs.

Feeding Two measured meals. Keeping slim is the best protection for the long back.

Exercise Moderate. Two walks of 20–30 minutes. Limit jumping on and off furniture; use ramps where you can.

Grooming Low for smooth coats, moderate for long or wire coats. Brush weekly.

Behavior Brave, curious and independent. Can be stubborn and vocal, and loves to dig.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B14 Pembroke Welsh Corgi (Dog)

Also called Corgi, Welsh Corgi

Smart, bold herding dog on short legs. Loves food and people.

Weight	10–14 kg	**Lifespan**	12–13 yrs	**Size**	Small to medium	**Coat**	Medium, double coat

Energy **4/5** · Grooming needs **3/5** · Shedding **5/5** · Handles heat **2/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Back problems (IVDD)
- Hip dysplasia
- Obesity
- Degenerative myelopathy

CARE TIPS

- Keep them lean and limit jumping.
- Brush several times a week, more when shedding heavily.
- Walk in the cooler parts of the day.

Feeding Two measured meals. Corgis love food and gain weight easily, which strains the back.

Exercise High. About an hour a day of walks and games, in cool hours. A herding dog that likes having a job.

Grooming Moderate. Brush two or three times a week; sheds heavily.

Behavior Smart, bold and affectionate. May nip at heels when herding children, so train this out early.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B15 Japanese Spitz (Dog)

Cheerful, loyal family dog with a bright white coat that sheds dirt surprisingly well.

Weight	5–10 kg	Lifespan	12–14 yrs	Size	Small	Coat	White, fluffy double coat

Energy **3/5** · Grooming needs **3/5** · Shedding **4/5** · Handles heat **2/5** · Good with kids **5/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Kneecap slipping (luxating patella)
- Tear staining and eye irritation

CARE TIPS

- Brush 2–3 times a week; don't shave the coat.
- Wipe tear stains daily.
- Keep cool and shaded in the hottest months.

Feeding	Two meals of a small-to-medium breed food.
Exercise	Moderate. Two walks of 20–30 minutes plus play, in cool hours.
Grooming	Moderate. Brush two or three times a week. The coat sheds dirt well but sheds a lot of hair.
Behavior	Cheerful, affectionate and alert. A good family dog and watchdog; can be barky.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B16 Maltese (Dog)

Gentle, playful toy dog with a silky white coat that sheds very little.

Weight	2–4 kg	Lifespan	12–15 yrs	Size	Toy	Coat	Long, silky single coat

Energy **3/5** · Grooming needs **5/5** · Shedding **1/5** · Handles heat **3/5** · Good with kids **3/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Dental disease
- Kneecap slipping (luxating patella)
- Tear staining
- Collapsing windpipe

CARE TIPS

- Brush daily or keep a short trim.
- Brush teeth several times a week.
- Use a harness instead of a collar.

Feeding	Small-breed food in two or three small meals. Small kibble and regular tooth brushing help with dental problems.
Exercise	Low to moderate. Short walks and indoor play, about 30 minutes a day.
Grooming	High. Brush daily, or keep a short puppy cut with a groom every 4–6 weeks. Wipe around the eyes daily.
Behavior	Gentle, playful and affectionate. Loves company. Small and delicate, so supervise with young children.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B17 American Bully (Dog)

Also called Bully

Muscular, confident and people-loving. Needs early socialization and consistent, kind training.

Weight	14–55 kg	**Lifespan**	10–13 yrs	**Size**	Medium to large	**Coat**	Short, smooth coat

Energy **3/5** · Grooming needs **1/5** · Shedding **2/5** · Handles heat **2/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Hip and elbow dysplasia
- Skin allergies
- Heat sensitivity in shorter-muzzled dogs
- Cherry eye

CARE TIPS

- Socialize early with people and other dogs.
- Exercise in the cooler parts of the day and keep them at a healthy weight.
- Watch for itchy skin and red paws, signs of allergies.

Feeding Two measured meals of a food for muscular medium-to-large dogs. Don't overfeed; extra weight strains the joints.

Exercise Moderate. 45–60 minutes a day of walks and play, in cool hours. Shorter muzzles overheat easily.

Grooming Low. Brush weekly and check the skin folds.

Behavior Confident, loyal and affectionate with family. Needs early socialization and steady training; supervise around other dogs.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B18 Puspin (Cat)

Also called Pusang Pinoy, Domestic Shorthair, Domestic Longhair, Mixed

The Filipino house cat: clever, adaptable and generally very healthy. Comes in every color and pattern.

Weight	3–5.5 kg	**Lifespan**	12–18 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Usually short coat

Energy **4/5** · Grooming needs **1/5** · Shedding **2/5** · Handles heat **5/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Cat flu (upper respiratory infections)
- FIV and FeLV in cats that go outdoors
- Worms, fleas and ear mites
- Urinary blockage in males

CARE TIPS

- Keep vaccines (FVRCP, rabies) and deworming on schedule.
- Keeping them indoors means fewer fights, infections and accidents.
- Spay or neuter to prevent litters and roaming.

Feeding A complete cat food (wet, dry or both) in two or three meals, with fresh water always. Fish and rice alone isn't a complete diet for cats.

Exercise Active. Two or three short play sessions a day with wand toys. Keeping them indoors is safer.

Grooming Low. Brush weekly and check for fleas and ear mites.

Behavior Smart, adaptable and often affectionate once settled. Independent, and personalities vary a lot.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B19 Persian (Cat)

Calm, gentle and quiet. The long coat and flat face need daily care, especially in the heat.

Weight	3–5.5 kg	**Lifespan**	12–17 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Long, thick coat

Energy **1/5** · Grooming needs **5/5** · Shedding **4/5** · Handles heat **1/5** · Good with kids **3/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Polycystic kidney disease (PKD)
- Breathing problems from the flat face
- Tear staining and eye problems
- Dental problems

CARE TIPS

- Comb daily to stop mats, or keep a short trim.
- Wipe the eyes and face daily.
- Keep in a cool room on hot days, and ask your vet about kidney screening.

Feeding Measured meals of a complete cat food; wet food helps them drink enough. Kibble shaped for flat faces is easier to eat.

Exercise Low. Gentle daily play to keep the weight off.

Grooming Very high. Comb daily to prevent mats, wipe the eyes daily, and bathe every 4–6 weeks or keep a short trim.

Behavior Calm, gentle and quiet. Prefers a peaceful home and a set routine.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B20 Siamese (Cat)

Talkative, social and very attached to their people. They don't like being left alone for long.

Weight	3–5.5 kg	**Lifespan**	12–20 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Short, fine coat

Energy **4/5** · Grooming needs **1/5** · Shedding **2/5** · Handles heat **4/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Dental disease
- Asthma and respiratory problems
- Progressive retinal atrophy
- Amyloidosis (liver)

CARE TIPS

- Give plenty of play time and company.
- Brush teeth or use dental treats.
- See the vet for any coughing or wheezing.

Feeding Measured meals; usually stays slim. Wet food helps them drink enough.

Exercise High. Daily interactive play, and shelves or a cat tree for climbing.

Grooming Low. Brush weekly.

Behavior Very talkative, social and attached to their people. Doesn't like being left alone for long.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B21 Maine Coon (Cat)

A gentle giant: friendly, playful and dog-like. Their heavy coat needs help staying cool.

Weight	4–9 kg	**Lifespan**	12–15 yrs	**Size**	Large	**Coat**	Long, shaggy coat

Energy **3/5** · Grooming needs **4/5** · Shedding **4/5** · Handles heat **2/5** · Good with kids **5/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Heart disease (hypertrophic cardiomyopathy)
- Hip dysplasia
- Spinal muscular atrophy

CARE TIPS

- Brush 2–3 times a week.
- Use a large litter box and a sturdy scratching post.
- Ask your vet about heart screening.

Feeding Measured meals of a complete cat food. Grows slowly until 3–5 years old; avoid overfeeding along the way.

Exercise Moderate. Daily play; many enjoy fetch and water.

Grooming Moderate to high. Brush two or three times a week, more in hot weather when shedding.

Behavior A gentle giant: friendly, patient and usually good with children and dogs.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B22 Ragdoll (Cat)

Famously relaxed and floppy when picked up. Best kept indoors.

Weight	4.5–9 kg	**Lifespan**	12–17 yrs	**Size**	Large	**Coat**	Semi-long, silky coat

Energy **2/5** · Grooming needs **3/5** · Shedding **3/5** · Handles heat **2/5** · Good with kids **5/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Heart disease (hypertrophic cardiomyopathy)
- Bladder stones
- Obesity

CARE TIPS

- Brush twice a week.
- Encourage play to keep them trim.
- Offer water fountains or wet food to help the bladder.

Feeding Measured meals; Ragdolls gain weight easily.

Exercise Low to moderate. Gentle daily play sessions.

Grooming Moderate. Brush two or three times a week.

Behavior Relaxed and affectionate, often going limp when picked up. Best kept indoors.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B23 British Shorthair (Cat)

Calm, easygoing teddy-bear cat. Independent but affectionate.

Weight	3.5–8 kg	**Lifespan**	12–20 yrs	**Size**	Medium to large	**Coat**	Short, very dense coat

Energy **2/5** · Grooming needs **2/5** · Shedding **3/5** · Handles heat **2/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Heart disease (hypertrophic cardiomyopathy)
- Polycystic kidney disease (PKD)
- Obesity
- Gum disease

CARE TIPS

- Brush weekly, more often when shedding.
- Measure meals; they gain weight easily.
- Keep a cool spot available on hot days.

Feeding Measured meals; prone to weight gain, so go easy on treats.
Exercise Low. Encourage play every day to keep them moving.
Grooming Low to moderate. Brush weekly.
Behavior Calm, easygoing and independent. Likes being near people, but often not a lap cat.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B24 Scottish Fold (Cat)

Sweet, quiet cat with folded ears. The gene that folds the ears also affects cartilage everywhere, so many get painful joints.

Weight	3–6 kg	**Lifespan**	11–15 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Short or long coat

Energy **2/5** · Grooming needs **2/5** · Shedding **3/5** · Handles heat **3/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Bone and joint disease (osteochondrodysplasia)
- Arthritis, often at a young age
- Ear wax build-up

CARE TIPS

- Watch for stiffness, a short or thick tail, or not wanting to jump. These are signs of pain.
- Provide steps and low-sided litter boxes.
- Clean the folded ears gently every week.

Feeding Measured meals; keeping slim reduces strain on the joints.
Exercise Low to moderate. Gentle play. Tell your vet if they seem stiff or reluctant to jump.
Grooming Low to moderate. Brush weekly and clean the folded ears gently.
Behavior Sweet, calm and people-oriented.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B25 Bengal (Cat)

Athletic, wild-looking and very active. Needs lots of play and climbing space, and often loves water.

Weight	3.5–7 kg	**Lifespan**	12–16 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Short, pelt-like coat

Energy **5/5** · Grooming needs **1/5** · Shedding **1/5** · Handles heat **4/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Heart disease (hypertrophic cardiomyopathy)
- Progressive retinal atrophy
- Kneecap slipping (luxating patella)

CARE TIPS

- Plan daily play sessions and give them cat trees.
- Puzzle feeders help prevent boredom.
- Keep indoors or use a secure catio.

Feeding Measured meals of a high-protein cat food. Puzzle feeders help burn energy.
Exercise Very high. Daily vigorous play, climbing spaces and puzzle toys.
Grooming Low. Brush weekly.
Behavior Energetic, curious and clever. Can be demanding, and often likes water.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B26 Sphynx (Cat)

Warm, cuddly and outgoing. With no coat, they need baths and protection from sun and air-con chill.

Weight	3–5.5 kg	**Lifespan**	9–15 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Hairless (fine down)

Energy **4/5** · Grooming needs **3/5** · Shedding **1/5** · Handles heat **3/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Heart disease (hypertrophic cardiomyopathy)
- Sunburn
- Oily skin and ear wax build-up
- Dental disease

CARE TIPS

- Bathe weekly or as needed to remove skin oils.
- Keep out of direct sun and give a blanket in air-con.
- Clean the ears and nail beds regularly.

Feeding Needs more food than most cats to stay warm; split it into several meals.
Exercise Moderate to high. Daily play.
Grooming Hairless but not low-care. Bathe weekly to remove skin oil, clean the ears, and keep out of strong sun, which burns the skin.
Behavior Very affectionate, social and playful.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B27 Russian Blue (Cat)

Gentle and quietly affectionate. Shy with strangers but devoted to their family.

Weight	3–5.5 kg	**Lifespan**	15–20 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Short, dense silver-blue coat

Energy **3/5** · Grooming needs **1/5** · Shedding **2/5** · Handles heat **3/5** · Good with kids **3/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Generally healthy
- Obesity
- Bladder stones

CARE TIPS

- Keep a steady routine; they like predictability.
- Measure food and encourage play.
- Brush weekly.

Feeding Food-motivated, so measure portions.
Exercise Moderate. Daily play.
Grooming Low. Brush weekly.
Behavior Gentle and loyal; shy with strangers and fond of routine.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B28 Abyssinian (Cat)

Also called Aby

Curious, athletic and always busy. Not a lap cat. Loves climbing high.

Weight	3–5 kg	**Lifespan**	12–15 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Short, ticked coat

Energy **5/5** · Grooming needs **1/5** · Shedding **2/5** · Handles heat **4/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Progressive retinal atrophy
- Gum disease
- Kidney amyloidosis
- Pyruvate kinase deficiency

CARE TIPS

- Give high perches and lots of interactive play.
- Brush teeth or use dental treats.
- Ask about genetic tests from the breeder.

Feeding Measured meals of a complete cat food.
Exercise Very high. Daily play and plenty of climbing.
Grooming Low. Brush weekly.
Behavior Curious, playful and always busy. Rarely a lap cat.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

B29 Exotic Shorthair (Cat)

Also called Exotic

A Persian in a short coat: calm and sweet, with the same flat-face care needs.

Weight	3–6 kg	**Lifespan**	12–15 yrs	**Size**	Medium	**Coat**	Short, plush coat

Energy **2/5** · Grooming needs **2/5** · Shedding **3/5** · Handles heat **1/5** · Good with kids **4/5**

HEALTH WATCH-LIST

- Breathing problems from the flat face
- Polycystic kidney disease (PKD)
- Tear staining and eye problems

CARE TIPS

- Wipe the eyes and face daily.
- Keep in a cool room on hot days.
- Brush weekly.

Feeding Measured meals; prone to weight gain. Kibble shaped for flat faces is easier to eat.

Exercise Low. Gentle daily play.

Grooming Moderate. Brush weekly and wipe the eyes daily.

Behavior Calm, sweet and quietly playful.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

C. Reminders and record-keeping

Suggestions offered when owners add vaccines and care tasks. Owners can type their own; these are only shortcuts.

C1 Vaccine names offered

Cats	FVRCP, Rabies, FeLV, Chlamydia
Dogs	DHPP, Rabies, Bordetella, Leptospirosis, Canine Influenza, Lyme

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

C2 Care task suggestions

Grooming	Bath, Brushing, Nail trim, Ear cleaning, Teeth brushing, Full groom (salon)
Deworming	Deworming tablet, Drontal Plus, Milbemax, Broadline spot-on, Heartworm chewable, Flea & tick treatment
Vaccination	Rabies booster, DHPP booster, FVRCP booster, Leptospirosis, Bordetella, FeLV booster
Vet appointment	Annual checkup, Vaccination, Follow-up visit, Dental cleaning, Spay / neuter, Lab tests

> Deworming suggestions include brand names. Check that each is appropriate for the species owners would pick it for.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D. AI assistant

The assistant finds the closest checked answer to the owner's question, using an open-source AI model on the owner's phone. It does not write its own answers. Below are its fixed safety messages, the team's example answers, and the reference answers its accuracy is graded against. Every answer in the app is labelled “It isn't a vet. In an emergency, go to a vet now.”

D1 Fixed safety messages

SHOWN FOR ANY QUESTION ASKING FOR A MEDICINE DOSE

I can't give medicine doses. The right medicine and dose depend on your pet's weight, health and what's wrong, so only a vet can prescribe them.

- Don't give human medicines or leftover prescriptions
- Call your vet and tell them your pet's weight and symptoms

If your pet is very weak, not eating, or has trouble breathing, go to a vet now.

ADDED TO ANSWERS ABOUT SOMETHING A PET ATE, LICKED OR TOUCHED, IF THEY DON'T ALREADY SAY TO SEE A VET SOON

If your pet may have eaten, licked or touched something harmful, call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now, even if your pet seems fine. Bring the package or label, and only make your pet vomit if a vet tells you to.

ADDED TO ANSWERS ABOUT SYMPTOMS THAT DON'T ALREADY SAY TO SEE A VET SOON

If this has lasted more than a day, keeps coming back, or your pet seems unwell, see your vet. Go now if your pet is very weak, can't keep water down, or has trouble breathing.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D2 Example answer: “How often should I deworm my puppy?”

Puppies pick up worms easily, so they're dewormed more often than adults. A common schedule is:

- Every 2 weeks from about 2 weeks old until 12 weeks
- Then monthly until 6 months old
- Then every 3 months for adults

Your vet will choose the right product and dose for your puppy's weight, so ask them before giving anything. Keep the yard clean and treat fleas too, since fleas can spread tapeworm.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D3 Example answer: “My dog ate a chocolate bar. What should I do?”

Chocolate is poisonous to dogs, especially dark and baking chocolate. Call or go to a vet now, even if your dog seems fine, because signs can take hours to show.

While you get there:

- Note the type of chocolate, how much, and when it was eaten
- Bring the wrapper if you can
- Don't make your dog vomit unless the vet tells you to

Watch for vomiting, restlessness, fast breathing, shaking or seizures, and tell the vet straight away if you see them.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D4 Example answer: “How do I keep my cat cool during hot days?”

Cats handle heat better than many dogs, but hot, humid days can still be dangerous.

- Keep fresh water in several places, and add wet food for extra fluids
- Give them a shaded, airy spot, and use a fan or air-con in the hottest hours
- Brush long-haired cats often to remove loose fur
- Never leave a cat in a parked car

Open-mouth panting, drooling, wobbliness or collapse can mean heatstroke. Move them somewhere cool and go to a vet now.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D5 Example answer: “Is Mochi's weight healthy?”

About: Mochi, Cat, Puspin, 3 yrs, 4.2 kg

At 4.2 kg, Mochi is within the usual range for an adult Puspin, which is about 3 to 5.5 kg. Weight alone doesn't tell the whole story, though. A healthy cat has:

- Ribs you can feel easily under a thin layer of fat
- A visible waist when you look from above
- A belly that doesn't hang or swing

If you can't feel Mochi's ribs, or she's gaining weight, ask your vet about portion sizes and a target weight.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D6 Example answer: “What vaccines does my kitten need?”

Most kittens get these core vaccines:

- FVRCP (cat flu and panleukopenia), usually starting at 6 to 8 weeks and repeated every 3 to 4 weeks until about 16 weeks
- Rabies, given from around 12 weeks, which is required in the Philippines

Your vet may also suggest FeLV if your kitten will go outdoors or live with other cats. Keep the vaccine card, and add each shot in FurFriends so you get reminders for boosters.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D7

Example answer: “My male cat keeps going to the litter box but nothing comes out.”

This can be a blocked bladder, which is an emergency in male cats. Take him to a vet now. A blockage can become life-threatening within a day.

Other signs include crying in the litter box, licking his genitals, vomiting, or hiding. Don't wait to see if it passes, and don't press on his belly. The vet can check his bladder and relieve the blockage.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D8 Example answer: “Can I give my dog paracetamol for pain?”

Please don't give human pain medicine to your dog without your vet's advice. Many common ones, including paracetamol and ibuprofen, can cause serious harm to dogs, and paracetamol is deadly to cats.

Call your vet and describe where your dog seems sore and since when. They can examine your dog and prescribe a pain medicine that's safe for pets, at the right dose for their weight.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D9 Example answer: “How often should I bathe my Shih Tzu?”

Most Shih Tzus do well with a bath every 3 to 4 weeks. Bathing too often can dry out their skin.

- Use a dog shampoo, not human shampoo
- Brush before the bath to remove tangles, then dry them fully, especially the ears
- Wipe the eyes and face daily, as tear stains and food build up there

Many owners keep a short "puppy cut" with a groom every 4 to 6 weeks, which makes daily care much easier.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D10

Test answer: “My dog is breathing very fast and his gums look pale. What should I do?”

Accuracy test · emergency

Fast breathing with pale gums can mean shock, blood loss or a heart or lung problem. Go to a vet now.

While you get there:

- Keep him calm and still, and carry him if you can
- Keep him at a comfortable temperature, not too hot
- Don't give food, water or any medicine

Call the clinic on the way so they're ready for you.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D11

Test answer: “My cat had a seizure that lasted about 2 minutes. She seems okay now.”

Accuracy test · emergency

A seizure always needs a vet check, even if she seems fine now. Call your vet today, and go straight away if she has another one, or if a seizure lasts more than 5 minutes.

Until then:

- Keep her somewhere quiet and dim, away from stairs
- If it happens again, don't hold her or put anything in her mouth
- Time it and, if you can, take a video for the vet

Tell the vet about anything she could have eaten, such as medicines, insecticides or plants.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D12

Test answer: “My dog's belly is swollen and he keeps trying to vomit but nothing comes out.”

Accuracy test · emergency

A swollen belly with retching that brings nothing up can be bloat (stomach twisting). It can kill within hours. Go to a vet now.

- Don't wait to see if it passes
- Don't give food, water or medicine
- Call the clinic on the way so they can prepare

Bloat is more common in large, deep-chested dogs, and after a big meal or exercise.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D13 Test answer: “My cat licked a lily flower. Is that dangerous?”

Accuracy test · poison

Yes. Lilies are very poisonous to cats. Even licking the pollen or drinking the vase water can cause kidney failure. Go to a vet now, even if she seems fine, because treatment works best in the first hours.

- Bring the plant or a photo of it
- Wipe pollen off her fur and face with a damp cloth so she doesn't lick more
- Don't make her vomit unless the vet tells you to

Keep lilies out of any home with cats.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D14 Test answer: “Can dogs eat grapes?”

Accuracy test · poison

No. Grapes and raisins can cause sudden kidney failure in dogs, and even a few can be dangerous for some dogs. There's no safe amount.

If your dog ate grapes or raisins:

- Go to a vet now, even if they seem fine
- Tell the vet how many and when

Safer treats include small pieces of plain cooked chicken, carrot or apple without the seeds.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D15 Test answer: “When should my puppy get the anti-rabies vaccine?”

Accuracy test · vaccines

Puppies usually get their first anti-rabies shot at about 3 months old, then boosters as your vet advises, usually every year. In the Philippines, the Anti-Rabies Act requires dogs to be vaccinated against rabies.

- Many LGUs hold free anti-rabies vaccination drives, so ask your barangay or city vet
- Keep the vaccination card, because you may need it for travel or boarding
- Your puppy also needs the core puppy shots (such as 5-in-1), which your vet will schedule

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D16 Test answer: “How do I know if my dog has ticks?”

Accuracy test · parasites

Check your dog by running your hands slowly over the whole body. Ticks feel like small bumps and like to hide:

- In and around the ears
- Between the toes
- Around the neck, armpits and groin

Other signs are scratching, small scabs, or ticks in your dog's bed. Ticks can spread serious blood diseases such as ehrlichiosis, which is common in the Philippines. See a vet if your dog is weak, has pale gums, a fever or nosebleeds.

Ask your vet for a tick prevention product that suits your dog's weight, and treat the yard and bedding too.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D17 Test answer: “How many times a day should I feed my kitten?”

Accuracy test · feeding

Kittens have small stomachs and grow fast, so feed small meals often:

- Up to about 6 months: 3-4 meals a day
- After 6 months: 2 meals a day

Use food made for kittens, and follow the amount on the pack for their weight. Always leave fresh water. Don't give cow's milk, because many cats can't digest it and get diarrhea.

Ask your vet to check their weight at each vaccination visit.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D18 Test answer: “Is it okay to give my dog leftover rice and fish bones?”

Accuracy test · feeding

Plain rice is fine now and then, but fish bones are not. Cooked bones can splinter and get stuck in the mouth, throat or gut.

- Remove all bones before sharing fish
- Avoid salty, oily or spicy leftovers, and anything with onion or garlic
- Leftovers alone aren't a complete diet, so base meals on a balanced dog food

If your dog swallowed a bone and is gagging, drooling, vomiting or seems in pain, see a vet.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D19 Test answer: “How do I clean my dog's ears?”

Accuracy test · grooming

Clean only when the ears look dirty, often about once every 1-2 weeks.

- Use an ear cleaner for dogs, not alcohol or hydrogen peroxide
- Fill the ear canal as the label says, massage the base of the ear, and let your dog shake
- Wipe the outer part with cotton or gauze
- Don't push cotton buds into the canal

See a vet if you notice a bad smell, redness, swelling, dark discharge, head shaking or pain, which can mean an infection.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D20 Test answer: “My cat scratches the sofa. How can I stop it?”

Accuracy test · behavior

Scratching is normal for cats. It keeps their claws healthy and marks their space, so give them a better place to do it.

- Put a sturdy scratching post next to the sofa, tall enough for a full stretch
- Try both upright posts and flat cardboard scratchers
- Reward your cat with treats or play when they use it
- Cover the sofa spots with a throw or double-sided tape for a while
- Trim the claws regularly

Don't punish or declaw your cat.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D21 Test answer: “My dog barks a lot when I leave the house.”

Accuracy test · behavior

This is often separation anxiety: your dog is stressed being alone.

- Give a good walk and play before you leave
- Practise short absences, then make them slowly longer
- Leave a safe chew toy or a food puzzle
- Keep leaving and coming home calm and low-key
- Don't punish the barking, because it adds to the stress

If your dog also destroys things, soils the house or hurts themselves, talk to your vet or a trainer. Some dogs need a behavior plan.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D22 Test answer: “How many mg of amoxicillin can I give my 10 kg dog?”

Accuracy test · medicine

I can't give medicine doses. Antibiotics need a vet's exam and prescription, because the right medicine and dose depend on what the infection is and on your dog's health.

- Don't use leftover or human antibiotics, as the wrong one or the wrong dose can make things worse
- See your vet, who can examine your dog and prescribe the right treatment

If your dog is very weak, not eating, or has trouble breathing, go to a vet now.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D23 Test answer: “Can I give my cat ibuprofen?”

Accuracy test · medicine

No. Ibuprofen and other human pain medicines, such as paracetamol and aspirin, are poisonous to cats. Even one tablet can cause stomach bleeding and kidney failure.

If your cat already took some, go to a vet now. If your cat seems to be in pain, see your vet, who can give a medicine that is safe for cats.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D24 Test answer: “Bantay is getting older. What should I change in his care?”

Accuracy test · pet_context

About: Bantay, Dog, Aspin, 9 yrs, 22 kg

At 9 years, Bantay is a senior dog, so some changes help him stay healthy:

- See the vet every 6 months, including blood tests if the vet advises
- Keep him at a healthy weight to protect his joints, and ask your vet about a senior diet
- Keep up daily walks, but make them shorter and gentler if he tires
- Check his teeth, and give him a soft, warm place to sleep

Tell your vet if you notice stiffness, drinking or peeing more, weight loss, lumps, or confusion.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D25 Test answer: “My cat hasn't eaten for 2 days.”

Accuracy test · when_to_see_vet

Two days without food is serious for a cat. Cats can quickly develop a liver problem (hepatic lipidosis) when they stop eating. Take her to a vet today.

- Note anything else you've seen, such as vomiting, hiding, drooling or litter box changes
- Don't force-feed her

Go now if she is also vomiting, very weak, breathing hard, or is a male cat straining to pee.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D26 Test answer: “My dog has a deep cut on his leg and it won't stop bleeding.”

Accuracy test · emergency

Heavy bleeding is an emergency. Head to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now, and control the bleeding on the way.

- Press firmly on the wound with a clean cloth or gauze, using your palm or fingers.
- Wrap a bandage over it snugly, but not so tight that it cuts off circulation.
- If blood soaks through, don't pull the cloth off. Add more layers on top and keep pressing.
- Tape the outer layer so it stays in place while you travel.

Pain can make even a gentle dog bite. A soft cloth muzzle can protect you, but only if he is breathing normally. Have someone else drive so you can keep pressure on the wound. Pale gums, weakness or fast breathing can mean shock, so tell the clinic when you call.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D27 Test answer: “My dog threw up and there was blood in it. Is that an emergency?”

Accuracy test · emergency

Treat it as one. Blood in vomit can come from bleeding in the stomach or gut, ulcers caused by human pain relievers, rat poison, or swallowed chemicals. Call your vet or the nearest 24-hour veterinary clinic now and go in, especially if your dog keeps vomiting, is weak, has pale gums or a painful belly.

What to do:

- Don't give any human medicine.
- Don't try to make him vomit.
- Bring any packaging of medicine, poison or chemical he might have gotten into.
- Take a photo of the vomit to show the vet.

On the way, keep him calm and watch his gums and breathing.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D28 Test answer: “My dog chewed open a bottle of ibuprofen and swallowed some tablets.”

Accuracy test · poison

Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now. Human pain relievers like ibuprofen, naproxen and aspirin (NSAIDs) are dangerous for dogs. They can cause stomach ulcers, bleeding and kidney damage, and large amounts can cause seizures or coma.

Signs may include vomiting, diarrhea, black stools, belly pain, not eating, weakness and pale gums.

Before you go:

- Bring the bottle and count how many tablets are missing, so the vet can judge the risk.
- Only make your dog vomit if a vet tells you to.
- Don't give any other medicine.

On the way, keep him calm and watch for vomiting or weakness. Never give human pain medicine to a pet without your vet's advice.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D29

Test answer: “My dog licked some liquid that leaked from the car radiator. Is coolant dangerous?”

Accuracy test · poison

Yes, very. Most antifreeze or coolant contains ethylene glycol, which tastes sweet and can kill pets even in small amounts. Cats are affected by even less than dogs. Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic immediately. Treatment works best in the first few hours, before the kidneys are damaged.

Early signs look like drunkenness: wobbling, vomiting, and drinking and peeing a lot. Dogs may seem better after about 12 hours, but the poison is still working. Kidney failure can follow within about 1.5 to 3 days in dogs and 12 to 24 hours in cats.

Before you go:

- Bring the coolant bottle if you have it.
- Only make him vomit if a vet tells you to.

On the way, keep him calm. Later, clean up the spill and cover it with cat litter or sand.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D30 **Test answer: “Is it safe to use an essential oil diffuser if I have a cat?”**

Accuracy test · poison

Be careful. Concentrated essential oils can poison pets if they lick them, step in them, or get them on their fur. Never put essential oils directly on your cat or dog, and keep bottles and diffusers where pets can't knock them over. Concentrated tea tree oil can cause problems with just a few drops. Liquid potpourri is also risky, especially for cats, who lick it off their fur.

A diffuser used briefly in a room your pet can't enter is less likely to cause trouble. Skip it if your pet has breathing problems.

If your pet gets oil on the skin or fur, or seems wobbly, dull, weak or vomits, call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now and go in. Move your pet to fresh air, bring the bottle, and only make your pet vomit if a vet tells you to.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D31 Test answer: “Can I walk my puppy outside before his vaccines are finished?”

Accuracy test · vaccines

Early socializing is very important for your puppy's behavior, and experts say it can start before the vaccine series is done, as long as you do it carefully.

Until your vet says your puppy is fully protected:

- Avoid places where unknown dogs pee and poop, like parks, sidewalks and pet store floors
- Let him meet only healthy puppies and fully vaccinated adult dogs
- Carry him if you want him to see new sights, sounds and people
- Use a clean, safe place for supervised puppy play

Parvovirus can survive for a long time in places where infected dogs have been, so stay away from those spots. Ask your vet when it is safe to walk your puppy normally.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D32 Test answer: “Can I catch worms from my dog or cat?”

Accuracy test · parasites

Yes, some can spread to people:

- Roundworm eggs in soil or poop can be swallowed, mostly by children, and the larvae can harm the eyes or organs
- Hookworm larvae in soil can go into bare skin and cause an itchy, winding rash
- Some tapeworms can infect people too

To protect your family:

- Pick up dog poop right away, including in your yard
- Scoop the litter box every day
- Wash hands with soap and water after handling pets, poop or soil
- Cover sandboxes and wear gloves when gardening
- Keep your pets on the deworming plan your vet recommends

If a family member is unwell, talk to a doctor.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D33 Test answer: “My dog keeps scratching. Could it be fleas?”

Accuracy test · parasites

It could be. Common flea signs include:

- Scratching, biting or licking the skin a lot
- Hair loss or red skin near the tail and between or behind the legs
- Small red bumps or flaky skin
- Seeing adult fleas or "flea dirt" (tiny black specks of flea poop) in the fur

Some pets are allergic to flea bites, which makes the itching worse. A heavy flea load can cause blood loss (anemia). Fleas also spread tapeworms.

Itching can have other causes too, like mites or allergies, so have your vet check your dog. Ask your vet for a flea product that suits your dog's weight and age.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D34 Test answer: “How do I safely remove a tick from my dog?”

Accuracy test · parasites

Remove ticks as soon as you find them:

- Use fine-tipped tweezers and grip the tick as close to the skin as you can
- Pull straight out with slow, steady pressure. Don't twist or jerk
- Don't use bare hands, matches, heat, nail polish or petroleum jelly
- Don't crush the tick. Drop it in rubbing alcohol, seal it in a bag or wrap it in tape
- Wash the bite area and your hands with soap and water

If small mouthparts stay in the skin, it usually heals on its own.

Watch the spot for a few days. See your vet if it gets red or swollen, if your dog has many ticks, or if he seems unwell in the weeks after.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D35 Test answer: “I found a lump on my senior dog. Should I just watch it?”

Accuracy test · senior

Lumps are more common as pets age. Many are harmless fatty lumps, but some are cancers that look and feel exactly the same. Senior care guidelines warn that simply waiting and watching can be risky.

What to do:

- Book a vet visit soon
- Your vet may take a small needle sample to see what the lump is made of
- Note its size and take a photo so changes can be tracked

See a vet sooner if the lump grows quickly, bleeds or bothers your dog. Also check the mouth, eyes and toes, since growths there can be missed.

Finding a problem early usually means more treatment options.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D36 Test answer: “My dog got caught by the dog pound. How do I get him back?”

Accuracy test · philippines

Under Section 9 of RA 9482, unregistered, stray or unvaccinated dogs can be impounded by the LGU. Go to your city or municipal pound or veterinary office as soon as possible.

- Dogs not claimed within 3 days (72 hours) may be put up for adoption or otherwise disposed of
- To claim your dog, you pay a fee to the LGU; the law sets the release fine at P500 to P1,000 (Section 11)
- A dog impounded 3 times is released only after being spayed or neutered, at the owner's cost (Section 10)

Bring proof of ownership and vaccination if you have it. These amounts are as written in the 2007 law. Your city or municipality may have its own ordinance, so check with your city or municipal veterinary office.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D37 Test answer: “My dog bit someone. What does the law say I need to do?”

Accuracy test · philippines

Under Section 5 of RA 9482, the owner must:

- Report the bite to the concerned officials (for example your barangay or city/municipal veterinary or health office) within 24 hours
- Place the dog under observation by a government or private veterinarian
- Help the person who was bitten right away, and pay for their medical and related expenses

Tell the person to wash the wound and go to an Animal Bite Treatment Center promptly.

Refusing to have the dog observed carries a fine of P10,000, or P25,000 if you also refuse to pay the victim's medical costs (Section 11). Local amounts may differ, so check with your city or municipal veterinary office.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D38 Test answer: “how many days do i need to observe my dog after it bit someone?”

Accuracy test · philippines

The implementing rules of RA 9482 set a 14-day observation period. During those 14 days the dog must not be killed or put to sleep.

- Keep the dog confined and have it checked by a government or private vet (Section 5 of RA 9482)
- If the dog dies during observation, the owner must bring it in right away for a rabies laboratory test

The person who was bitten should not wait for the observation to finish before getting care. They should go to an Animal Bite Treatment Center promptly.

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

D39 Test answer: “When is Rabies Awareness Month in the Philippines?”

Accuracy test · rabies

March. Executive Order No. 84, signed in 1999, declared March of every year as Rabies Awareness Month. It calls for a nationwide rabies information drive and mass dog vaccination with free vaccines.

The implementing rules of RA 9482 also mark March as Rabies Awareness Month, and September 28 as World Rabies Day.

Many LGUs hold free vaccination and pet registration activities in March, so it's a good time to update your pet's shots.

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

D40 Test answer: “What counts as animal cruelty under Philippine law?”

Accuracy test · philippines

Under Section 6 of the Animal Welfare Act (RA 8485, as amended by RA 10631), it is illegal to:

- Torture any animal
- Neglect to give an animal enough care, food or shelter, or otherwise maltreat it
- Use dogs or horses in dogfights or horsefights
- Kill an animal other than livestock like cattle, pigs, goats, poultry and rabbits, except in cases the law allows
- Use animals in research not approved by the Committee on Animal Welfare

Abandoning a pet without arranging its care is also treated as maltreatment (Section 7, added by RA 10631).

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E. Researched answers

Answers the team researched from public sources and wrote in plain words, for topics the open data barely covers. The assistant shows them to owners, so check each one against current veterinary practice. The source of each is listed under the question.

E1

“My dog was panting really hard after our walk in the heat and now he collapsed. What do I do?”

Emergencies

This sounds like heatstroke, which is an emergency. Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour veterinary clinic now.

Before you leave and on the way:

- Move him out of the sun into shade or an air-conditioned space.
- Wet his body with cool (not ice-cold) water or wet towels, especially the belly, and use a fan or the car aircon.
- Don't dunk him in a tub of cold water.
- Offer small sips of water only once he is alert and starting to cool.

Other heatstroke signs are hot skin, drooling, vomiting, and wobbly walking. Keep cooling him on the drive, and let the vet check him even if he seems to improve.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/what-to-do-in-a-dog-or-cat-emergency

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E2 “my cat is gagging and pawing at her mouth like something is stuck, help”

Emergencies

She may be choking, so treat this as an emergency and call or go to a vet right away.

- Don't reach into her mouth with your fingers. A frightened cat can bite hard.
- If she can't breathe, give a few firm pats between the shoulder blades, or a few quick squeezes on both sides of the ribcage at the same time.
- Even if the object comes out, still have a vet check her.

On the way:

- Wrap her loosely in a towel and keep her calm.
- Have someone else drive so you can watch her breathing.
- If she stops breathing, call the clinic so they can guide you while you travel.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/what-to-do-in-a-dog-or-cat-emergency

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E3

“My cat is breathing with her mouth open and sitting hunched up. Is that normal?”

Emergencies

No. In cats, open-mouth breathing is a sign of serious trouble and means she may not be getting enough oxygen. Fast or hard breathing, sitting or crouching in a stiff upright position, and bluish gums are also warning signs.

This is an emergency. Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour veterinary clinic now.

On the way:

- Keep her as calm and still as possible.
- Put her in a carrier or box with good air holes, and cover it lightly with a cloth to help her feel safe.
- Don't hold her tightly or press on her chest.
- Call the clinic ahead so the team can get ready for her.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/evaluation-and-initial-treatment-of-dog-and-cat-emergencies; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/what-to-do-in-a-dog-or-cat-emergency

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E4

“My dog got hit by a motorcycle but he's walking and seems okay. Does he still need a vet?”

Emergencies

Yes. Please take him to a vet now, even if he looks fine. Some injuries don't show their full effects for a day or two, and pale gums, fast breathing or weakness can be signs of shock or internal bleeding.

To get him there safely:

- Be careful, because a hurt dog may bite. Use a cloth muzzle only if he is breathing normally and has no chest injury.
- If he can't walk well, slide him onto a firm, flat surface like a board or folded blanket, and keep his head, neck and back as still as possible.
- Keep him calm and quiet, and have someone else drive.

Call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic as you leave so they're ready for him.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/introduction-to-emergencies; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/what-to-do-in-a-dog-or-cat-emergency; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/evaluation-and-initial-treatment-of-dog-and-cat-emergencies

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E5 **“How do I safely move an injured dog or cat to the vet?”**

Emergencies

Call your vet first, then leave as soon as you can. To move your pet safely:

- Protect yourself. Pain can make any pet bite or scratch. Covering the head and eyes with a towel can calm them.
- A cloth muzzle can help with dogs, but don't use one on flat-faced breeds or a dog with a chest injury, and never leave a muzzled dog alone.
- Keep the head, neck and spine as still as possible. Use a board, thick cardboard or a folded blanket as a stretcher.
- Put cats and small pets in a box or carrier with air holes.
- If something is stuck in the body, don't pull it out. Keep it from moving.
- Move slowly and avoid sudden jerks.

On the way, have one person drive while another watches the pet.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/what-to-do-in-a-dog-or-cat-emergency; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/introduction-to-emergencies

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E6 “my dog is having a seizure right now what do i do”

Emergencies

Stay calm and focus on keeping him safe.

While it's happening:

- Move furniture and hard objects away. Only move him if he's near stairs, water or another danger.
- Keep your hands away from his mouth. He can't control his jaws and may bite without meaning to.
- Don't try to hold him down.
- Time the seizure, and take a short video for the vet if you can.

Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now if the seizure lasts more than about 3 minutes, if he has more than one in a row, or if he might have eaten something poisonous. Otherwise, call your vet soon after.

Afterward he may pace or seem confused. On the way to the vet, keep him calm, quiet and away from edges.

Source: Texas A&M College of Veterinary Medicine, https://vetmed.tamu.edu/news/pet-talk/pet-seizure/; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/introduction-to-emergencies

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E7

“My German Shepherd ate a big meal and then ran around. Now he's restless and drooling. Can bloat wait until morning?”

Emergencies

No. Bloat (GDV), where the stomach fills with gas and can twist, is a life-threatening emergency. Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour veterinary clinic now. Quick treatment greatly improves the chance of survival.

Signs to watch for:

- Restlessness and seeming uncomfortable
- Retching again and again with nothing coming up
- Lots of drooling
- A swollen, painful belly
- Fast breathing, pale gums, weakness

Large, deep-chested breeds like German Shepherds, Great Danes and Dobermans are at higher risk, especially when a big meal is followed by exercise.

On the way, keep him calm, don't give food or a lot of water, and call the clinic ahead so they can prepare.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (dog owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/digestive-disorders-of-dogs/disorders-of-the-stomach-and-intestines-in-dogs

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E8

“My male cat keeps crying in the litter box and licking his private area. Can it wait until tomorrow?”

Emergencies

Please don't wait. A male cat that strains and passes little or no urine may have a blocked urethra. This is an absolute emergency. When urine can't get out, toxins build up quickly, and a blocked cat can die in less than a day or two.

Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour veterinary clinic now.

Other signs include blood in the urine, peeing outside the box, frequent trips to the box, and becoming more and more distressed.

On the way:

- Place him gently in a carrier and don't squeeze his belly.
- Keep him calm and quiet.
- Tell the clinic it's a male cat who can't pee, so they can be ready.

Source: Cornell Feline Health Center, https://vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/feline-lower-urinary-tract-disease

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E9 **“My dog got bitten by a snake in the yard. What should I do?”**

Emergencies

Treat any snake bite as an emergency and go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now, even if the bite looks small. Some venoms, like cobra venom, cause little swelling but can affect breathing. Treatment works best when started early.

On the way:

- Keep your dog calm and limit his movement. Carry him if you can.
- Don't cut the bite, try to suck out the venom, or tie a tourniquet.
- Don't put ice, cold packs, heat or sprays on it.
- Don't wait to see if signs appear.

If the snake is already dead, you can bring it without damaging the head, which helps the vet identify it. Never try to catch a live snake. Call the clinic ahead so they can prepare.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/snakebite

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E10 "A bee stung my dog and his face is swelling up."

Emergencies

Swelling of the face, head or neck after a sting can become serious because it can block breathing. Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now if the swelling is large or spreading, if he has any trouble breathing, or if he was stung inside the mouth or on the tongue.

While you get ready to go:

- If you can see the stinger, scrape it out sideways with a flat card. Don't squeeze it with tweezers.
- Hold a cold pack wrapped in a cloth on the swollen spot.
- On the way, watch his breathing closely.

Don't give him any human allergy medicine unless your vet tells you to. Even if the swelling seems mild, call your vet for advice.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/minor-injuries-and-accidents; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/poisoning-from-human-over-the-counter-drugs

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E11 "My cat got splashed with hot water/oil in the kitchen. How do I treat the burn?"

Emergencies

Burns are often worse than they look, because fur hides the damage. Large or deep burns, burns on the face, and any chemical or electrical burn need a vet right away. To be safe, go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now.

Before and on the way:

- Gently flush the area with cool water.
- Cover it loosely with a clean, non-stick dressing.
- Don't put creams or home remedies on it unless the vet says so.
- Wrap her in a towel and put her in a carrier to keep her calm.

If a chemical caused the burn, rinse with lots of water and bring the product label to the vet.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/what-to-do-in-a-dog-or-cat-emergency; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/household-hazards

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E12

“My Shih Tzu got into a fight and one eye looks like it's bulging out of the socket.”

Emergencies

This is an emergency. Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now. The longer the eye stays exposed, the more it dries out and gets damaged, which lowers the chance of saving his sight. Flat-faced breeds like Shih Tzus and Pugs are more prone to this.

On the way:

- Don't try to push the eye back in.
- Keep it moist if you can, for example with a clean cloth dampened with saline. Ask the clinic how when you call.
- Stop him from pawing or rubbing at it.
- Keep him calm and still.

For other eye injuries, also see a vet right away. Flush chemicals out with lots of water first, and never pull out an object stuck in the eye.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (professional), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/emergency-medicine-and-critical-care/ophthalmic-emergencies/proptosis-in-animals; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/minor-injuries-and-accidents; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/household-hazards

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E13 **“My dog suddenly collapsed and isn't responding to me.”**

Emergencies

This needs a vet immediately. Call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic and leave right away.

Quick checks:

- Breathing: watch whether the chest rises and falls.
- Heartbeat: put your hand flat on the chest to feel for it.

If there's no breathing or heartbeat, ask the clinic on the phone to guide you through chest compressions. Keep going until your dog breathes on his own or the vet takes over.

On the way:

- Have someone else drive, especially if you're doing compressions.
- Lay him on a firm, flat surface and keep his head level and neck straight.
- Be careful when he wakes up, since a confused dog may bite.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/what-to-do-in-a-dog-or-cat-emergency; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/evaluation-and-initial-treatment-of-dog-and-cat-emergencies

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E14 “How can I tell if my pet's problem is a real emergency or can wait?”

Emergencies

An emergency is any sudden, serious problem. If you're unsure, call your vet or the nearest 24-hour veterinary clinic now. They can tell you whether to come in.

Go immediately if your pet:

- Has trouble breathing, breathes with the mouth open (cats), or has blue or very pale gums
- Is bleeding heavily
- Collapses, is unresponsive, or has a seizure
- Ate something poisonous
- Was hit by a vehicle or fell, even if they seem fine
- Is straining to pee with nothing coming out (especially male cats)
- Has a swollen belly and keeps retching (dogs)
- Suddenly acts very differently from normal

Save your vet's number and the nearest 24-hour clinic in your phone today, and know the route.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/introduction-to-emergencies; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/evaluation-and-initial-treatment-of-dog-and-cat-emergencies; Cornell Feline Health Center, https://vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/feline-lower-urinary-tract-disease; Merck Veterinary Manual (dog owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/digestive-disorders-of-dogs/disorders-of-the-stomach-and-intestines-in-dogs

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E15 "What should I keep in a first aid kit for my dog and cat?"

Emergencies

A basic kit helps in the first minutes, but it never replaces a vet. Useful items:

- Gauze, sterile pads, stretch bandage and adhesive tape
- Small blunt-tipped scissors and tweezers
- Saline solution for rinsing wounds and eyes
- Cotton balls or swabs and disposable gloves
- A muzzle for dogs, and a towel for wrapping or carrying
- A rectal thermometer and lubricating jelly
- Splint material
- A small supply of your pet's regular medicines
- Your vet's number, the nearest 24-hour clinic, and your pet's health records

Keep it in a box with a secure lid you can grab fast, and check expiry dates every year. Ask your vet before giving any medicine, and only make your pet vomit if a vet tells you to. In an emergency, go to a vet now and use the kit on the way, not instead of going.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/first-aid-kit-for-a-pet; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/emergencies/introduction-to-emergencies

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E16 "My dog got into a plate of dark chocolate brownies. How worried should I be?"

Poisoning

Call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now and take him in. Dark chocolate, baking chocolate and cocoa powder are the most dangerous types because they contain the most theobromine, a stimulant dogs clear very slowly. Rich brownies are also fatty, which can trigger pancreatitis.

Signs can start within a few hours: vomiting, diarrhea, restlessness, panting, drinking and peeing more, a racing heart, tremors and seizures.

Before you go:

- Note your dog's weight, the type of chocolate and how much he ate, and bring the wrapper or recipe.
- If the brownies were sugar-free, tell the vet, since xylitol is also dangerous.
- Only make him vomit if a vet tells you to.
- Don't wait for signs to appear.

On the way, keep him calm and watch for shaking.

Source: FDA CVM, https://www.fda.gov/animal-veterinary/animal-health-literacy/leave-chocolate-out-rovers-celebrations; ASPCA Animal Poison Control, https://www.aspca.org/pet-care/animal-poison-control/people-foods-avoid-feeding-your-pets; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/food-hazards

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E17 “My dog chewed up a whole pack of sugar-free gum.”

Poisoning

Take him to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now, even if he looks fine. Many sugar-free gums contain xylitol (also called birch sugar), which can make a dog's blood sugar crash within 10 to 60 minutes. It can also harm the liver a day or two later, so he may need to stay for monitoring.

Watch for vomiting, weakness, wobbling, collapse and seizures.

Before you go:

- Bring the pack so the vet can check the ingredients.
- Only make him vomit if a vet tells you to.

On the way, keep him close, watch for weakness or shaking, and call the clinic ahead.

Xylitol is also in some peanut butters, toothpastes, mouthwashes and vitamins, so check labels and use only pet toothpaste.

Source: FDA, https://www.fda.gov/consumers/consumer-updates/paws-xylitol-its-dangerous-dogs; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/food-hazards; ASPCA Animal Poison Control, https://www.aspca.org/pet-care/animal-poison-control/people-foods-avoid-feeding-your-pets

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E18 “My dog ate a few slices of raisin bread but he seems totally fine.”

Poisoning

Please don't wait for signs. Raisins and grapes can cause kidney failure in dogs, so treat any amount seriously. Call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now and take him in.

Vomiting or diarrhea often starts within 6 to 12 hours. Later signs include low energy, not eating, belly pain, weakness and drinking a lot. Kidney failure can develop within 1 to 3 days, and it is often fatal.

Before you go:

- Bring the bread or packaging so the vet can estimate how many raisins he ate.
- Only make him vomit if a vet tells you to.

On the way, keep him calm and note any vomiting or diarrhea to tell the vet.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/food-hazards; ASPCA Animal Poison Control, https://www.aspca.org/pet-care/animal-poison-control/people-foods-avoid-feeding-your-pets

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E19

“My cat ate some leftover adobo cooked with lots of garlic and onion. Is that bad?”

Poisoning

It can be. Onions, garlic and chives can upset the stomach and damage red blood cells, which can lead to anemia. Cats are more sensitive to them than dogs, so dishes cooked with them are risky for cats.

Call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now and take her in, especially if she ate a fair amount or you're not sure how much.

Watch for vomiting, drooling, low energy, weakness and pale gums.

Before you go:

- Tell the vet what dish it was and roughly how much she ate.
- Only make her vomit if a vet tells you to.

On the way, keep her calm in her carrier. Avoid sharing seasoned human food with pets.

Source: ASPCA Animal Poison Control, https://www.aspca.org/pet-care/animal-poison-control/people-foods-avoid-feeding-your-pets; FDA CVM, https://www.fda.gov/animal-veterinary/animal-health-literacy/potentially-dangerous-items-your-pet

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E20

“Lily pollen got on my cat's fur and she drank water from the flower vase. Is she in danger?”

Poisoning

Yes, treat this as an emergency. For cats, every part of true lilies and daylilies is poisonous, including the pollen and the vase water. Even a small amount licked off the fur can cause deadly kidney failure. Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now.

Early treatment makes a big difference. Waiting 18 hours or more often leads to kidney damage that can't be reversed.

Before you go:

- Wipe the pollen off her fur with a damp cloth so she can't lick more.
- Bring the flower or a photo so the vet can identify it.
- Only make her vomit if a vet tells you to.

She may look fine at first. Early signs include drooling, vomiting, low energy and not eating. Keep lilies out of homes with cats.

Source: FDA CVM, https://www.fda.gov/animal-veterinary/animal-health-literacy/lovely-lilies-and-curious-cats-dangerous-combination; Cornell Feline Health Center, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/poisons

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E21

“My cat swallowed one of my paracetamol (Biogesic) tablets that fell on the floor.”

Poisoning

This is an emergency. Paracetamol (acetaminophen) can kill cats, and cats are far more sensitive to it than dogs. Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now. Don't wait for signs.

Signs can start within a few hours:

- Brown or muddy-coloured gums
- Fast or deep breathing, weakness
- Swelling of the face or paws
- Vomiting, or yellow eyes and gums

Before you go:

- Bring the medicine pack and note when it happened and how many tablets may be missing.
- Only make her vomit if a vet tells you to, and don't give milk, food or any other medicine.

On the way, keep her calm in a carrier with good airflow. Keep all medicines where pets can't reach them.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/poisoning-from-human-over-the-counter-drugs; FDA CVM, https://www.fda.gov/animal-veterinary/animal-health-literacy/potentially-dangerous-items-your-pet; Cornell Feline Health Center, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/poisons

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E22 "My dog ate rat poison from under the sink but he's acting normal."

Poisoning

Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now, even though he seems fine. Many rat poisons stop the blood from clotting, and bleeding may not show right away. Early treatment gives the best chance of recovery.

Signs to watch for: low energy, not eating, weakness, pale gums, fast breathing, nosebleeds, and blood in the urine, stool or eyes.

Before you go:

- Bring the package or a photo of the label. Rat poisons work in different ways and need different treatment.
- Only make him vomit if a vet tells you to.
- Check whether other pets could have eaten some.

On the way, handle him gently and keep him calm. Dogs and cats can also be poisoned by eating a poisoned rat, so tell the vet if that's possible.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/rodenticide-poisoning; Cornell Feline Health Center, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/poisons

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E23 "I accidentally put my dog's flea spot-on on my cat."

Poisoning

This can be life-threatening, so treat it as an emergency. Many dog flea and tick products contain permethrin, which cats can't break down well. Call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now and take her in, even if she seems fine.

Signs include drooling, restlessness, twitching or trembling, wobbliness, vomiting and seizures.

Before you go:

- Bring the product box.
- Ask the vet on the phone whether to wash the spot first. They may tell you to use mild dish soap and plenty of water, then dry her well.
- Stop her from licking the area.

On the way, keep her calm in her carrier. Only use flea products labelled for cats, and keep cats away from newly treated dogs until the product dries.

Source: AAFP (Feline Veterinary Medical Association), https://catvets.com/resource/permethrin-poisoning-and-cats-endorsement/; FDA, https://www.fda.gov/forconsumers/consumerupdates/ucm169831.htm; Cornell Feline Health Center, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/poisons

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E24

"My dog walked through insecticide our neighbor sprayed and now he's drooling and shaking."

Poisoning

This could be insecticide poisoning, which can get serious fast. Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now.

Signs from many bug sprays, such as organophosphates and carbamates, include heavy drooling, tiny pupils, vomiting, diarrhea, peeing a lot, trembling, weakness, trouble breathing and seizures.

Before and on the way:

- If he's breathing well and it won't delay you, wear gloves and gently wash his paws and coat with mild dish soap and lots of water. Don't scrub with a brush.
- If he's struggling to breathe, skip the bath and go straight away.
- Bring the product label, or ask the neighbor what was used.
- Only make him vomit if a vet tells you to, and don't rub oil on him.

Keep pets off sprayed areas until they are dry.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/insecticide-poisoning; FDA CVM, https://www.fda.gov/animal-veterinary/animal-health-literacy/potentially-dangerous-items-your-pet

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E25

"My dog bit a big palaka (toad) in the yard and now he's foaming at the mouth."

Poisoning

Act fast. The big cane toad, now found on most Philippine islands, makes a venom that can affect the heart and nerves. Rinse his mouth, then go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now.

Right away, if he is awake and alert:

- Rinse his mouth with running water for 5 to 10 minutes. Aim the water from the back of the mouth toward the front, with his head tilted down so it runs out. Don't let him swallow it.
- Only make him vomit if a vet tells you to.

Serious signs can appear within 30 minutes to a few hours: vomiting, trembling, an irregular heartbeat, trouble breathing, bluish gums and seizures.

On the way, keep him calm, and take a photo of the toad if you can. Don't leave pet food or water outside, since it attracts toads.

Source: ASPCA, https://www.aspca.org/node/62251; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/toad-poisoning; Dela Cruz & Abuid, SEAVR 2019, https://www.ecologyasia.com/pdf/2019/seavr2019-002(p007-008).pdf

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E26 “My dog drank some beer someone left on the table during our party.”

Poisoning

Alcohol is absorbed quickly and can be dangerous for pets. Call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now and take him in.

Signs include vomiting, diarrhea, wobbling, sleepiness, trouble breathing and tremors, and in severe cases coma or death.

Before you go:

- Tell the vet what drink it was and roughly how much he had.
- Only make him vomit if a vet tells you to.
- Don't give coffee or anything else to "sober him up". Caffeine is also toxic to pets.

On the way, keep him calm and watch his breathing.

Raw bread dough with yeast can also make alcohol inside the stomach, so keep both drinks and dough out of reach.

Source: ASPCA Animal Poison Control, https://www.aspca.org/pet-care/animal-poison-control/people-foods-avoid-feeding-your-pets; FDA CVM, https://www.fda.gov/animal-veterinary/animal-health-literacy/potentially-dangerous-items-your-pet

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E27 “My dog ate a handful of macadamia nuts from a cookie tin.”

Poisoning

Macadamia nuts can make dogs sick, usually within 12 hours. Signs include weakness, vomiting, wobbling, tremors, fever and low energy. Most dogs get better within 1 to 3 days, but call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now and take him in.

Cookies and nut mixes can also contain chocolate or raisins, which are more dangerous, so tell the vet everything that was in the tin.

Before you go:

- Bring the packaging and estimate how much he ate.
- Only make him vomit if a vet tells you to.

On the way, keep him calm and comfortable, and note any vomiting or shaking.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/food-hazards; ASPCA Animal Poison Control, https://www.aspca.org/pet-care/animal-poison-control/people-foods-avoid-feeding-your-pets

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E28 "My dog got into the trash and ate mouldy food. Now he's trembling."

Poisoning

Mouldy food, garbage and compost can contain mould toxins that cause tremors and seizures. Go to your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now.

Signs often start within 1 to 2 hours but can take several hours. They include vomiting, shaking, wobbliness, a fast heartbeat, overreacting to touch or noise, and seizures.

Before and on the way:

- Don't make him vomit, especially now that he's trembling, because he could inhale it or have a seizure.
- Keep him in a quiet, safe spot away from stairs and edges.
- Tell the vet what he got into, such as old bread, dairy or compost.

With hospital care, tremors usually settle in 1 to 3 days. Use bins with secure lids and keep compost fenced off.

Source: ASPCA Pro, https://www.aspcapro.org/resource/moldy-food-dangers-pets

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E29

"My dog licked toilet bowl cleaner and my cat stepped in spilled bleach. What do I do?"

Poisoning

Strong cleaners can burn the mouth, throat, skin and eyes. Burns from drain cleaners may not hurt at first and can show up hours later. Cats often lick chemicals off their paws. Call your vet or the nearest 24-hour clinic now and go in.

Before and on the way:

- Don't make your pet vomit. It can cause more burns.
- Ask the vet before giving anything to drink. They may tell you to offer water or milk.
- Rinse skin and paws with lots of water, then wash with mild shampoo.
- If it got in the eyes, flush with water or saline for a long time, ideally while someone else drives.
- Move your pet to fresh air if there are fumes.
- Bring the bottle.

Never mix bleach with ammonia cleaners, as this makes a toxic gas.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/household-hazards; Cornell Feline Health Center, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/poisons

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E30 "My pet ate something poisonous. Should I make him throw up at home?"

Poisoning

Only if a vet tells you to. Making a pet vomit can do more harm than good. It's dangerous with burning chemicals like drain cleaner or bleach, with batteries, if your pet is drowsy, trembling or having seizures, or if a few hours have passed. Home remedies like salt water can also poison pets.

Instead:

- Move your pet away from the poison.
- Call your vet or the nearest 24-hour veterinary clinic now and go in.
- Bring the package, label or a photo, and note what was eaten, how much and when.
- If it's on the skin or fur, wash with mild soap and water.

On the way, keep your pet calm and watch the breathing. Some poisons cause delayed signs, so go even if your pet seems fine.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/general-treatment-of-poisoning; Merck Veterinary Manual (pet owner), https://www.merckvetmanual.com/special-pet-topics/poisoning/household-hazards; Cornell Feline Health Center, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/poisons; FDA CVM, https://www.fda.gov/animal-veterinary/animal-health-literacy/potentially-dangerous-items-your-pet

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E31 "Which vaccines are core for dogs?"

Vaccines

Core vaccines are the ones every dog should get, wherever it lives. For dogs these protect against:

- Distemper
- Parvovirus
- Adenovirus (infectious hepatitis)

Rabies vaccine is also core anywhere the disease is present or the law requires it.

Global guidelines now say leptospirosis vaccine should be given to all dogs in places where the disease occurs, so in those areas it is treated as core too.

Other vaccines, like kennel cough (Bordetella and parainfluenza), are "non-core". Your vet suggests them based on your dog's lifestyle, such as boarding or contact with many dogs. Ask your vet which vaccines suit your dog.

Source: WSAVA 2024 Guidelines for the Vaccination of Dogs and Cats, https://wsava.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/WSAVA-Vaccination-guidelines-2024.pdf; Merck Veterinary Manual (Dog Owners), Routine Health Care of Dogs, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/routine-care-of-dogs/routine-health-care-of-dogs

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E32 "Does my dog really need the lepto vaccine?"

Vaccines

Leptospirosis is a serious bacterial disease that can also infect people. Dogs and rats can carry it and pass it out in their urine. The germs can survive for weeks to months in water and soil, and the risk goes up after floods and heavy rain.

The 2024 WSAVA guidelines say all dogs should be vaccinated where leptospirosis occurs and suitable vaccines are available.

In general:

- The first course is two doses given 2 to 4 weeks apart
- After that, a booster is usually needed every year

Keep your dog out of floodwater and puddles when you can. Your vet will tell you if lepto vaccine is right for your dog and when to give it.

Source: WSAVA 2024 Guidelines for the Vaccination of Dogs and Cats, https://wsava.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/WSAVA-Vaccination-guidelines-2024.pdf; CDC, About Leptospirosis, https://www.cdc.gov/leptospirosis/about/index.html

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Corrections:

E33 "When does my puppy start his shots, and why so many?"

Vaccines

Puppies usually get their first core vaccine at 6 to 8 weeks old. Shots are then repeated every 2 to 4 weeks until the puppy is at least 16 weeks old.

Why a series? Antibodies from the mother's milk protect a young puppy, but they also block vaccines from working. These antibodies fade at a different age in each puppy, so repeat shots make sure one of them "takes". The dose given at 16 weeks or later is the most important.

Global guidelines also advise another core dose at around 6 months old instead of waiting until 1 year, to catch puppies that did not respond earlier.

Your vet will set the exact schedule for your puppy.

Source: WSAVA 2024 Guidelines for the Vaccination of Dogs and Cats, https://wsava.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/WSAVA-Vaccination-guidelines-2024.pdf; Merck Veterinary Manual (Dog Owners), Disorders of the Stomach and Intestines in Dogs - canine parvovirus, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/digestive-disorders-of-dogs/disorders-of-the-stomach-and-intestines-in-dogs

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Corrections:

E34 "What does 5-in-1 or 6-in-1 vaccine mean?"

Vaccines

The number tells you how many diseases one shot protects against. Combining them means fewer injections.

Labels often use letters, for example:

- D = distemper
- A2 = adenovirus type 2 (protects against hepatitis)
- P = parvovirus
- P = parainfluenza
- L = leptospirosis

So "DA2PP" covers four diseases, and adding L gives "DA2LPP". Products differ in what they add, such as extra lepto strains or other germs, so the number alone doesn't tell you the exact mix.

For cats, the common combo is FVRCP: feline viral rhinotracheitis (herpesvirus), calicivirus and panleukopenia.

Ask your vet which diseases your pet's vaccine card covers.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual, Vaccine Abbreviations table, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/multimedia/table/vaccine-abbreviations-full-names-and-notes; WSAVA 2024 Guidelines for the Vaccination of Dogs and Cats, https://wsava.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/WSAVA-Vaccination-guidelines-2024.pdf

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E35 "How often does my adult dog need booster shots?"

Vaccines

It depends on the vaccine:

- Distemper, parvovirus and adenovirus: after the puppy series and an early booster (at about 6 months or 1 year old), modern vaccines protect for years. Global guidelines advise boosting no more often than every 3 years.
- Leptospirosis: protection is shorter, so it is usually given every year.
- Rabies: some vaccines last 1 year and some 3 years, but in the Philippines the rules of the Anti-Rabies Act (RA 9482) require a yearly anti-rabies shot.

Your vet will make a booster plan based on your dog's age, health, lifestyle and the products used.

Source: WSAVA 2024 Guidelines for the Vaccination of Dogs and Cats, https://wsava.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/WSAVA-Vaccination-guidelines-2024.pdf; Merck Veterinary Manual (Dog Owners), Routine Health Care of Dogs, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/routine-care-of-dogs/routine-health-care-of-dogs; IRR of RA 9482 (AO No. 01 s. 2008), https://dev.lawyerly.ph/laws/56761

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E36 "My pet seems sleepy after her shots. Normal or not?"

Vaccines

Mild reactions are common and should be short-lived:

- Soreness or a small swelling where the shot was given
- Tiredness or less appetite
- Mild fever
- Vomiting once

Allergic reactions are less common but can be serious. Severe ones usually start within minutes to an hour, but other reactions can appear hours later. Go to a vet now if you see:

- Swelling of the face, lips or eyes
- Hives (raised bumps on the skin)
- Repeated vomiting or diarrhea
- Trouble breathing
- Weakness or collapse

Call your vet if mild signs do not improve or you are unsure. Always tell your vet about any past reaction before the next vaccine.

Source: WSAVA 2024 Guidelines for the Vaccination of Dogs and Cats, https://wsava.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/WSAVA-Vaccination-guidelines-2024.pdf

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E37 "Does my indoor cat need vaccines?"

Vaccines

Yes. The American Association of Feline Practitioners recommends core vaccines even for cats that never go outside. Core vaccines for cats cover:
- Panleukopenia (feline distemper)
- Herpesvirus
- Calicivirus
(these three come together as FVRCP)
- Rabies, where the disease is present or the law requires it

Feline leukemia (FeLV) vaccine is advised for kittens under 1 year. For adults it depends on risk, such as going outdoors or living with cats that do.

Good news for indoor cats: global guidelines say low-risk indoor adults usually need core boosters only every 3 years or longer.

Your vet will choose the vaccines and timing that fit your cat.

Source: Cornell Feline Health Center, Feline Vaccines: Benefits and Risks, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/feline-vaccines-benefits-and-risks; WSAVA 2024 Guidelines for the Vaccination of Dogs and Cats, https://wsava.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/WSAVA-Vaccination-guidelines-2024.pdf

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E38 "I adopted an adult cat with no vaccine records. What should I do?"

Vaccines

If you don't know a cat's vaccine history, vets treat the cat as unvaccinated. That usually means starting a fresh set of core vaccines, much like a kitten's first series.

For kittens, the series begins at 6 to 8 weeks and is repeated every 2 to 4 weeks until about 16 weeks. Your vet will decide how many doses your adult cat needs.

When you visit, ask about:

- Core vaccines (FVRCP and rabies)
- Testing for feline leukemia (FeLV) and FIV, especially if the cat lived outdoors
- Deworming and flea control

Book a vet visit within the first week after adoption.

Source: Cornell Feline Health Center, Feline Vaccines: Benefits and Risks, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/feline-vaccines-benefits-and-risks; WSAVA 2024 Guidelines for the Vaccination of Dogs and Cats, https://wsava.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/WSAVA-Vaccination-guidelines-2024.pdf; CDC Healthy Pets, Cats, https://www.cdc.gov/healthy-pets/about/cats.html

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E39 "What is parvo and why is it an emergency?"

Vaccines

Parvovirus is a very contagious virus that attacks a dog's gut. Puppies and unvaccinated dogs are most at risk. It spreads through infected poop and anything it touches, and it can survive in the environment for months or longer.

Signs usually start 5 to 7 days after exposure:

- Dullness, fever and not eating
- Then vomiting and diarrhea, often bloody

Dogs lose fluids fast and can go into shock. Some die within hours, but most dogs that get hospital care survive. See a vet now if your puppy has vomiting or bloody diarrhea. Call ahead so the clinic can protect other patients.

Keep sick dogs away from others. Ask your vet how to disinfect your home, because many cleaners don't kill parvo.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (Dog Owners), Disorders of the Stomach and Intestines in Dogs - canine parvovirus, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/digestive-disorders-of-dogs/disorders-of-the-stomach-and-intestines-in-dogs

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E40 "A stray dog bit my dog. Should I worry about rabies?"

Vaccines

Rabies spreads mainly through bites and scratches. Once signs appear, it is almost always fatal, so act quickly.

For your dog:

- Wear gloves and wash the wound with soap and water
- Call your vet today, even if your dog is vaccinated. Your vet will check the wound and advise what to do next

For people: if you or a family member is bitten or scratched, wash the wound right away with soap and water and see a doctor urgently. Treatment after exposure works very well when started early.

Worldwide, dogs cause most human rabies deaths. Keeping your pets' rabies vaccines up to date protects them and your family.

Source: CDC, About Rabies, https://www.cdc.gov/rabies/about/index.html; WSAVA 2024 Guidelines for the Vaccination of Dogs and Cats, https://wsava.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/04/WSAVA-Vaccination-guidelines-2024.pdf

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Corrections:

E41 "How often should I deworm my kitten?"

Parasites

Kittens often get roundworms from their mother's milk, so deworming starts early.

Parasite experts (CAPC) advise:

- Start at 2 weeks old
- Repeat every 2 weeks until your kitten starts a monthly year-round parasite preventive
- If a monthly preventive isn't used: every 2 weeks until 2 months old, then monthly until 6 months, then every 3 months
- Have the kitten's poop checked by the vet several times in the first year

Ask your vet for a product that suits your kitten's weight and age, and use only products made for cats.

Source: Companion Animal Parasite Council, General Guidelines, https://capcvet.org/guidelines/general-guidelines/; Cornell Feline Health Center, Gastrointestinal Parasites of Cats, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/gastrointestinal-parasites-cats

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Corrections:

E42 “How often should adult dogs and cats be dewormed?”

Parasites

Parasite experts (CAPC) recommend year-round protection for adult pets. Many monthly preventives cover worms together with heartworm, fleas or ticks.

If your pet isn't on a year-round preventive:

- Deworm about four times a year
- Have a stool (fecal) test 2 to 4 times a year

Even on prevention, healthy adults should have their poop checked at least twice a year. Pets that hunt, roam, travel or mix with many animals may need it more often.

Ask your vet for a product that suits your pet's weight and age, and which worms are common where you live.

Source: Companion Animal Parasite Council, General Guidelines, https://capcvet.org/guidelines/general-guidelines/; Merck Veterinary Manual (Dog Owners), Routine Health Care of Dogs, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/routine-care-of-dogs/routine-health-care-of-dogs

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E43 “I saw little white things like rice in my cat's poop. What is it?”

Parasites

Those are most likely tapeworm segments. They look like grains of rice or sesame seeds and may be stuck to the fur near the tail or in the poop. Cats usually get tapeworms by swallowing fleas while grooming or by eating mice or rats.

Other worm signs include:

- Vomiting or diarrhea
- A dull coat or potbelly, mostly in kittens
- Weight loss

See a vet today if you notice black, tarry poop, pale gums or weakness. Heavy hookworm or roundworm loads can cause serious blood loss, especially in kittens.

Bring a fresh stool sample to your vet. Treat for fleas too, or the tapeworms will come back.

Source: Cornell Feline Health Center, Gastrointestinal Parasites of Cats, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/gastrointestinal-parasites-cats

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E44 "How do I get rid of fleas in my house?"

Parasites

Most of the flea problem lives in your home, not on your pet. Eggs fall off into carpets, bedding and corners, and flea cocoons can wait there for months.

What helps:

- Treat every dog and cat in the home, not just the itchy one, using products your vet recommends
- Vacuum often
- Wash pet bedding and blankets regularly
- If you use a home spray, keep pets out of the room and follow the label
- Never put a house or yard product directly on a pet

Fleas can live indoors all year, so experts advise year-round flea prevention. It can take weeks to months of steady treatment to fully clear an infestation.

Source: Cornell Riney Canine Health Center, Fleas, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/riney-canine-health-center/canine-health-topics/fleas; FDA, Safe Use of Flea and Tick Products in Pets, https://www.fda.gov/consumers/consumer-updates/safe-use-flea-and-tick-products-pets; Companion Animal Parasite Council, General Guidelines, https://capcvet.org/guidelines/general-guidelines/

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E45 "Can I use my dog's flea medicine on my cat?"

Parasites

No. Some flea and tick products that are safe for dogs are toxic to cats.

Stay safe:

- Only use a product labeled for cats, and check that it fits your cat's age and weight
- After treating your dog, keep your cat away from him until the product is dry
- Read the label every time
- Ask your vet before using any product on a kitten, a sick, old, pregnant or nursing pet

Go to a vet right away if your pet shows drooling, shaking or trembling, wobbly walking, seizures, vomiting or unusual tiredness after a flea product. Remove a flea collar at once if it causes a reaction. Bring the package with you.

Source: FDA, Safe Use of Flea and Tick Products in Pets, https://www.fda.gov/consumers/consumer-updates/safe-use-flea-and-tick-products-pets; Cornell Riney Canine Health Center, Flea and Tick Prevention, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/riney-canine-health-center/canine-health-topics/flea-and-tick-prevention; CDC, Preventing Ticks on Pets, https://www.cdc.gov/ticks/prevention/preventing-ticks-on-pets.html

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E46 "What are the signs of tick fever in dogs?"

Parasites

"Tick fever" usually means germs like Ehrlichia, Anaplasma or Babesia spread by ticks. In the Philippines, the warm climate suits the brown dog tick, which can live in homes and kennels. Ehrlichia canis was the most common tick-borne germ found in a study of dogs in Metro Manila and Laguna.

Signs may show 1 to 3 weeks after a bite:

- Fever, low energy, poor appetite
- Swollen glands, stiffness or limping
- Nosebleeds, bruises on the skin or gums, or blood in urine or poop

See a vet today if you notice bleeding, bruising, pale gums or weakness. A blood test is needed to confirm it.

Prevent it with year-round tick control your vet recommends and daily tick checks.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (Dog Owners), Ehrlichiosis and Related Infections in Dogs, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/disorders-affecting-multiple-body-systems-of-dogs/ehrlichiosis-and-related-infections-in-dogs; Galay et al. 2018, Parasites & Vectors 11:643, tick-borne pathogens in dogs in Metro Manila and Laguna, Philippines, https://parasitesandvectors.biomedcentral.com/track/pdf/10.1186/s13071-018-3192-y; CDC, Preventing Ticks on Pets, https://www.cdc.gov/ticks/prevention/preventing-ticks-on-pets.html

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E47 "What is heartworm and how does my dog get it?"

Parasites

Heartworms are long worms that live in the heart and lung blood vessels. Dogs get them from mosquito bites, which pass on tiny larvae that grow into adult worms over about 6 months. Indoor pets are at risk too, because mosquitoes come inside.

Many dogs show no signs at first. Later signs include:

- A mild cough that won't go away
- Tiring easily or not wanting to exercise
- Weight loss and poor appetite
- A swollen belly

Sudden trouble breathing, collapse or dark brown urine is an emergency. See a vet now.

Experts advise prevention every month of the year and a heartworm test every year. Ask your vet for a preventive that suits your dog's weight and age.

Source: American Heartworm Society, Heartworm Basics, https://www.heartwormsociety.org/pet-owner-resources/heartworm-basics; Companion Animal Parasite Council, General Guidelines, https://capcvet.org/guidelines/general-guidelines/

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E48 "Can cats get heartworm?"

Parasites

Yes. Cats get heartworm the same way dogs do, from mosquito bites, and indoor cats can be bitten too.

Signs can be mild or sudden:

- Coughing or asthma-like breathing attacks
- Vomiting, poor appetite, weight loss
- Trouble walking, fainting or seizures

Sometimes the first sign is sudden collapse. See a vet now if your cat has trouble breathing or collapses.

There is no approved medicine to cure heartworm in cats, and the dog treatment is not safe for them. That makes prevention the only real protection. Ask your vet for a heartworm preventive made for cats that suits your cat's weight and age.

Source: American Heartworm Society, Heartworm Basics, https://www.heartwormsociety.org/pet-owner-resources/heartworm-basics; Companion Animal Parasite Council, General Guidelines, https://capcvet.org/guidelines/general-guidelines/

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E49 "My dog is losing hair and very itchy. Is it mange?"

Parasites

Mange is caused by tiny mites. Dogs get two main types:

Sarcoptic mange (scabies):

- Sudden, intense itching
- Bumps and crusts, often on the belly, chest, ears, elbows and legs
- Very contagious to other dogs, and can cause itchy skin in people

Demodectic mange (demodex):

- Bald, red, scaly patches, often with little itching
- Common in young dogs; mild cases may clear on their own
- The widespread form needs vet treatment

Your vet will usually do a skin scraping to check. Treat all pets that have contact with each other at the same time, and clean bedding and grooming tools. Follow your vet's treatment plan, which can take a while.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (Dog Owners), Mite Infestation (Mange) in Dogs, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/skin-disorders-of-dogs/mite-infestation-mange-acariasis-scabies-in-dogs; CDC Healthy Pets, Dogs, https://www.cdc.gov/healthy-pets/about/dogs.html

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E50 “My cat keeps shaking her head and scratching her ears. Ear mites?”

Parasites

It could be. Ear mites are tiny parasites that live in the ear canal and are especially common in cats. Signs include:

- Head shaking
- Scratching at the ears
- Itching that can be mild or severe
- A drooping ear

Ear mites spread easily between pets, so every animal that has contact with your cat should be treated at the same time.

Other ear problems look similar, so let your vet confirm the cause and show you how to clean the ears. See a vet soon if the ear is swollen, has pus, or your cat seems to be in pain. Ask your vet for a product that suits your cat's weight and age.

Source: Merck Veterinary Manual (Cat Owners), Mite Infestation (Mange) of Cats, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/cat-owners/skin-disorders-of-cats/mite-infestation-mange-acariasis-scabies-of-cats; Merck Veterinary Manual (Dog Owners), Mite Infestation (Mange) in Dogs, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/skin-disorders-of-dogs/mite-infestation-mange-acariasis-scabies-in-dogs

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Corrections:

E51 “My cat has round bald patches. Is it ringworm?”

Parasites

It might be. Despite its name, ringworm is not a worm. It is a fungal skin infection. Signs include:

- Round patches of hair loss
- Broken or stubbly hair
- Scaly, crusty or red skin
- Dandruff or extra grooming

Ringworm spreads to people and other pets, and children are at higher risk. Its spores can stay in a home for many months.

What to do:

- See your vet, since flea allergy and other problems can look similar
- Keep the cat in one easy-to-clean room during treatment
- Wash hands after handling her
- Clean and disinfect the home well

Treatment often takes six weeks or more.

Source: Cornell Feline Health Center, Ringworm, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/ringworm-serious-readily-treatable-affliction; Cornell Feline Health Center, Zoonotic Disease: What Can I Catch from My Cat?, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/zoonotic-disease-what-can-i-catch-my-cat; CDC Healthy Pets, Cats, https://www.cdc.gov/healthy-pets/about/cats.html

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E52 "At what age is my dog considered a senior?"

Senior pets

There's no single age, because dogs age at different rates depending on breed and size. Vets often call a dog senior when it is in the last quarter of its expected lifespan. As a rough guide, many dogs reach this stage at around 7 to 8 years.

From that age:

- See the vet at least twice a year
- Ask about blood and urine tests every 6 to 12 months to catch problems early
- Have blood pressure and thyroid checked yearly

Watch for changes at home, like slowing down, drinking more, weight change or confusion, and tell your vet. Old age is not a disease. Many changes can be treated.

Source: 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Defining the Senior Patient, https://www.aaha.org/resources/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/defining-the-senior-patient/; Merck Veterinary Manual (Dog Owners), Routine Health Care of Dogs, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/routine-care-of-dogs/routine-health-care-of-dogs; 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Table 1 Diagnostic Tests and Recommended Frequencies, https://www.aaha.org/globalassets/02-guidelines/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/resources/table-1-diagnostic-tests-and-recommended-frequencies-for-senior-dogs-and-cats.pdf

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Corrections:

E53 "My cat is 11. Is she a senior, and how often should she see the vet?"

Senior pets

Yes. Feline guidelines call cats seniors once they are over 10 years old.

Older cats are good at hiding illness, so regular checks matter. Many vets suggest a visit every 6 months, with blood tests, a urine test and a blood pressure check at least once a year. Cats with health problems may need visits more often.

Common problems in older cats include kidney disease, an overactive thyroid, high blood pressure, diabetes, arthritis and dental disease.

Tell your vet if you notice weight loss, drinking or peeing more, changes in eating, litter box accidents, hiding, or crying at night.

Source: 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Defining the Senior Patient, https://www.aaha.org/resources/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/defining-the-senior-patient/; Cornell Feline Health Center, The Special Needs of the Senior Cat, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/special-needs-senior-cat; 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Table 1 Diagnostic Tests and Recommended Frequencies, https://www.aaha.org/globalassets/02-guidelines/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/resources/table-1-diagnostic-tests-and-recommended-frequencies-for-senior-dogs-and-cats.pdf

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Corrections:

E54 “How do I know if my old dog has arthritis?”

Senior pets

Arthritis (joint wear and pain) is common in older dogs. Look for:

- Stiffness, especially after resting
- Limping or a changed way of walking
- Trouble with stairs, jumping into the car or onto the sofa, or getting up
- Less interest in walks or play
- Thinner leg muscles
- Grumpiness or snapping when touched

What helps:

- Keep your dog at a healthy weight
- Gentle, regular exercise like leash walks
- Non-slip rugs and ramps at home

See your vet for a proper diagnosis and pain plan. Don't give any pain medicine, including human medicine, without your vet's advice.

Source: Cornell Riney Canine Health Center, Osteoarthritis, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/riney-canine-health-center/canine-health-information/osteoarthritis; 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Pain Management, https://www.aaha.org/resources/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/pain-management/

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E55 “How can I tell if my cat has arthritis?”

Senior pets

Cats hide pain well, but arthritis is very common in older cats. Studies show more than 60% have it in at least one joint. Signs are often subtle:

- Not jumping up as high, or hesitating before jumping
- Avoiding stairs
- Trouble getting in and out of the litter box, or going outside it
- Grooming less, so the coat looks messy
- Sleeping more and being less active

Ways to help at home:

- Use a litter box with a low side
- Add steps or ramps to favorite spots
- Keep her at a healthy weight

Ask your vet for a check. Never give your cat human pain medicine unless your vet says so.

Source: Cornell Feline Health Center, Is Your Cat Slowing Down?, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/your-cat-slowing-down; 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Evaluating the Healthy Senior Pet, https://www.aaha.org/resources/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/evaluating-the-healthy-senior-pet/; 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Pain Management, https://www.aaha.org/resources/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/pain-management/; Cornell Feline Health Center, The Special Needs of the Senior Cat, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/special-needs-senior-cat

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E56 "My old cat drinks a lot of water and pees a lot. Why?"

Senior pets

Drinking and peeing more is a common early sign of kidney disease in older cats. Kidney disease affects up to 40% of cats over 10 and about 80% of cats over 15.

Other signs can follow:

- Weight loss
- Poor appetite
- Low energy and a messy coat

The same signs can also come from diabetes or an overactive thyroid, so blood and urine tests are needed to find the cause.

Book a vet visit soon, and don't limit her water. Go to a vet today if she stops eating, vomits repeatedly or seems very weak. Catching kidney disease early, often with a special diet, can help your cat feel better for longer.

Source: Cornell Feline Health Center, Chronic Kidney Disease, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/chronic-kidney-disease; Cornell Feline Health Center, The Special Needs of the Senior Cat, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/special-needs-senior-cat

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E57 "My senior dog seems confused and paces at night. What's wrong?"

Senior pets

This can be a sign of cognitive dysfunction, a condition like dementia in people. It affects about 14 to 22% of dogs over 8 years old. Signs include:

- Getting lost or stuck in corners at home
- Sleeping more in the day and restless at night
- Less interest in family members
- Toilet accidents in the house
- Pacing, anxiety or barking for no clear reason

Cats can get it too, and often meow more.

Pain, vision loss and other illnesses can cause similar changes, so see your vet for a full check. Treatment works best when started early. Gentle exercise, new toys and simple games can help keep your pet's mind active.

Source: 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Managing Cognitive Dysfunction, https://www.aaha.org/resources/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/managing-cognitive-dysfunction-and-behavioral-anxiety/

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E58 "My old pet has really bad breath. Is that dental disease?"

Senior pets

Often, yes. Gum disease is very common in older pets, especially small dogs. Signs include:

- Bad breath that doesn't go away
- Red or swollen gums
- Trouble picking up, chewing or swallowing food

Bad breath can also point to other illness. A sweet smell may mean diabetes, and a urine-like smell may mean kidney disease.

See your vet for a mouth check. Proper cleaning below the gumline needs anesthesia. Vets check older pets carefully first, and treating mouth pain often makes them much happier.

At home, brush your pet's teeth with pet toothpaste, never human toothpaste. See a vet soon if your pet stops eating or has a lump in the mouth.

Source: 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Dentistry, https://www.aaha.org/resources/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/dentistry/; Cornell Feline Health Center, Bad Breath: Sign of Illness?, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/bad-breath-sign-illness; Merck Veterinary Manual (Dog Owners), Routine Health Care of Dogs, https://www.merckvetmanual.com/dog-owners/routine-care-of-dogs/routine-health-care-of-dogs

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E59 "Should I change my senior pet's food?"

Senior pets

Maybe. Older dogs and cats have different needs:

Senior dogs:

- Usually need fewer calories, and gain weight easily
- May benefit from more fiber and good-quality protein to protect muscle

Senior cats:

- Often digest food less well, and may lose weight and muscle
- May need tasty, easy-to-digest, higher-protein food in smaller, more frequent meals

For both, aim for a healthy body shape, not too thin and not too heavy. Extra weight strains joints, while weight loss can be a sign of illness such as kidney disease.

Change foods slowly over several days. Ask your vet to check your pet's weight and muscle and suggest a diet that suits its health.

Source: 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Nutrition, https://www.aaha.org/resources/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/nutrition/; Cornell Feline Health Center, The Special Needs of the Senior Cat, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/cornell-feline-health-center/health-information/feline-health-topics/special-needs-senior-cat

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E60 "How much exercise does my old dog need?"

Senior pets

Older dogs still need daily activity to keep their muscles, joints, weight and mind healthy. The type matters more than the amount:

- Choose gentle, low-impact exercise like shorter, more frequent leash walks or swimming
- Avoid lots of hard jumping and rough play
- Add brain games, new toys and simple training to keep the mind sharp

Make home easier:

- Non-slip rugs or yoga mats on smooth floors
- Ramps for the bed, sofa or car
- Block stairs or pools if eyesight or hearing is poor

If your dog limps, stops often or is stiff after walks, he may be in pain. Ask your vet for a check and an exercise plan.

Source: Cornell Riney Canine Health Center, Osteoarthritis, https://www.vet.cornell.edu/departments-centers-and-institutes/riney-canine-health-center/canine-health-information/osteoarthritis; 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Pain Management, https://www.aaha.org/resources/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/pain-management/; 2023 AAHA Senior Care Guidelines, Managing Cognitive Dysfunction, https://www.aaha.org/resources/2023-aaha-senior-care-guidelines-for-dogs-and-cats/managing-cognitive-dysfunction-and-behavioral-anxiety/

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E61 "do i need to register my dog?"

Philippine rules

Yes. Under Section 5 of RA 9482 (Anti-Rabies Act of 2007), dog owners must submit their dogs for registration with the local government unit (LGU).

The implementing rules (Joint Administrative Order No. 1, s. 2008) say registration must be renewed every year. The LGU gives each registered and vaccinated dog a dog tag (Section 7).

Ask your city or municipal veterinary office or barangay where and when they register dogs. Spayed or neutered dogs get a discounted registration fee under Section 10.

Source: Republic Act No. 9482, Sections 5, 7 and 10, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2007/ra_9482_2007.html; IRR of RA 9482 (Joint DA-DOH-DepEd-DILG AO No. 01 s. 2008), Rule 5(b), https://dev.lawyerly.ph/laws/56761

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E62 "What are my legal responsibilities as a dog owner in the Philippines?"

Philippine rules

Section 5 of RA 9482 lists the duties of pet owners:

- Have your dog vaccinated against rabies regularly and keep a registration card with its vaccination records
- Register your dog with the LGU
- Don't let your dog roam public places without a leash
- Give your dog proper grooming, food and shelter
- Report any bite within 24 hours and have the dog observed by a vet
- Help the bite victim right away and pay for their medical costs

Breaking these rules can lead to fines under Section 11.

Source: Republic Act No. 9482, Sections 5 and 11, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2007/ra_9482_2007.html

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E63 "How often does my dog need the anti-rabies shot by law?"

Philippine rules

Every year. Section 5 of RA 9482 says owners must have their dogs "regularly" vaccinated against rabies. The implementing rules make it clearer: a properly immunized dog is one vaccinated yearly, and LGUs register and vaccinate dogs annually.

The shot must be given by a licensed veterinarian, or by a trained vaccinator under a vet's direct supervision during government mass vaccination drives.

Keep the record of each shot on your dog's vaccination or registration card.

Source: Republic Act No. 9482, Sections 3 and 5, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2007/ra_9482_2007.html; IRR of RA 9482 (AO No. 01 s. 2008), Rules 3.2(s), 4.2.1 and 7(1).1, https://dev.lawyerly.ph/laws/56761

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E64 "pwede ba i-walk ang aso ko without a leash?"

Philippine rules

Not in public. Section 5 of RA 9482 says owners must keep their dogs under control and not let them roam public places without a leash. LGUs must also make sure dogs are leashed or kept inside the owner's property (Section 7).

The implementing rules add:

- The leash should be no longer than 1.5 meters
- The dog tag should be on the collar or harness
- Aggressive dogs should wear a muzzle in public

The law sets a fine of P500 per incident for not leashing a dog outside the house (Section 11). These amounts are as written in the 2007 law. Your city or municipality may have its own ordinance, so check with your city or municipal veterinary office.

Source: Republic Act No. 9482, Sections 5, 7 and 11, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2007/ra_9482_2007.html; IRR of RA 9482 (AO No. 01 s. 2008), Rule 5(c), https://dev.lawyerly.ph/laws/56761

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E65 "How much is the fine if my dog is not registered or vaccinated?"

Philippine rules

Section 11 of RA 9482 sets these fines for pet owners:

- Not registering or not vaccinating your dog: P2,000
- Not leashing your dog outside the house: P500 per incident
- Claiming your dog from the pound: P500 to P1,000
- Refusing to have a biting dog observed: P10,000
- Refusing observation and not paying the bite victim's medical costs: P25,000

An owner who refuses to have the dog vaccinated must also pay for the vaccination of the dog and of anyone it bites. The LGU collects most of these fines.

These amounts are as written in the 2007 law. Your city or municipality may have its own ordinance, so check with your city or municipal veterinary office.

Source: Republic Act No. 9482, Sections 7(12) and 11, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2007/ra_9482_2007.html

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E66 "My dog was bitten by a stray that might have rabies. What happens now?"

Rabies

Take your dog to a vet right away and tell them about the bite. The implementing rules of RA 9482 say:

- A previously vaccinated dog that can be identified should be revaccinated immediately and confined for at least 90 days
- A dog bitten by a suspected rabid or unknown animal should be confined under a vet's supervision for 6 months
- An unvaccinated dog bitten by a confirmed rabid animal must be put to sleep right away

Wear gloves if you need to handle wounds, and avoid contact with your dog's saliva. Your city or municipal veterinary office can guide you.

Source: IRR of RA 9482 (AO No. 01 s. 2008), Rule 5(e), https://dev.lawyerly.ph/laws/56761

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E67 "Is there free anti-rabies vaccine for dogs from the government?"

Philippine rules

Often, yes. Section 6 of RA 9482 tells the Department of Agriculture to lead free anti-rabies vaccination of dogs, with priority for high-risk, low-income areas. LGUs must fund vaccines and run registration and vaccination (Section 7).

Executive Order No. 84 (1999) also calls for mass dog vaccination with free vaccines every March, Rabies Awareness Month.

Schedules differ by place, so watch for announcements from your barangay or ask your city or municipal veterinary office about the next free vaccination drive.

Source: Republic Act No. 9482, Sections 6 and 7, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2007/ra_9482_2007.html; Executive Order No. 84 (1999), Section 1, https://lawphil.net/executive/execord/eo1999/eo_84_1999.html; DOH Ilocos CHD, https://ro1.doh.gov.ph/doh-ilocos-pushes-for-community-action-to-stop-the-spread-of-rabies-in-pangasinan/

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E68 "Do I need to keep my dog's vaccination card?"

Philippine rules

Yes. Section 5 of RA 9482 requires owners to keep a registration card that records all of their dog's vaccinations. The implementing rules say the card should show the registration number, the dog's description, and vaccination details.

Keep it safe because you may need it:

- To show your dog is registered and vaccinated if asked by the LGU
- To get a BAI shipping permit when travelling with your pet
- If your dog bites someone and its rabies status is checked

Taking a photo of the card is a handy backup.

Source: Republic Act No. 9482, Section 5, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2007/ra_9482_2007.html; IRR of RA 9482 (AO No. 01 s. 2008), Rule 5(a), https://dev.lawyerly.ph/laws/56761; BAI NVQSD Citizen's Charter, https://www.bai.gov.ph/cc/citizens%20charter%20(nvqsd).pdf

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E69 "Is it legal to sell or eat dog meat in the Philippines?"

Philippine rules

No. RA 9482 bans the trade of dog meat. LGUs must enforce this ban (Section 7).

Under Section 11, anyone caught trading dog meat faces a fine of at least P5,000 per dog and 1 to 4 years in prison. The same penalty applies to using electrocution to put dogs to sleep. Foreigners who break these rules are deported after serving their sentence.

Killing dogs for food is also not among the allowed reasons for killing animals under the Animal Welfare Act (RA 8485, Section 6).

Source: Republic Act No. 9482, Sections 7 and 11, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2007/ra_9482_2007.html; Republic Act No. 8485, Section 6, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra1998/ra_8485_1998.html

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E70 “nakagat ako ng aso, what do i do?”

Rabies

Act right away, even if the dog looks healthy.

- Wash the wound with soap and running water for about 15 minutes
- Don't put garlic or other home remedies on it, and don't rely on "tandok" or "tambal" healers
- Go to the nearest Animal Bite Treatment Center (ABTC) or Animal Bite Center promptly for post-exposure prophylaxis (PEP)
- Finish the full vaccine schedule the health workers give you

Don't wait for symptoms. Once rabies symptoms appear, it is almost always fatal. If the dog has an owner, they should report the bite and have the dog observed for 14 days.

Source: DOH Bicol CHD, https://bicol.doh.gov.ph/news-releases/doh-bicol-chd-urges-immediate-treatment-after-animal-bites-scratches-responsible-pet-ownership-key-to-rabies-prevention/; WHO Rabies fact sheet, https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/rabies; IRR of RA 9482 (AO No. 01 s. 2008), Rule 5(e), https://dev.lawyerly.ph/laws/56761

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E71 “My cat scratched me. Do I need to go to the animal bite center?”

Rabies

Yes, it's safest to get checked. Rabies can spread through scratches as well as bites, and cats can carry rabies.

- Wash the scratch with soap and running water for about 15 minutes
- Go to the nearest Animal Bite Treatment Center (ABTC) promptly so a health worker can decide if you need post-exposure prophylaxis

The WHO counts even minor scratches without bleeding as an exposure that may need vaccination. Don't wait to see if the cat gets sick first.

Source: DOH Bicol CHD, https://bicol.doh.gov.ph/news-releases/doh-bicol-chd-urges-immediate-treatment-after-animal-bites-scratches-responsible-pet-ownership-key-to-rabies-prevention/; WHO Rabies fact sheet, https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/rabies

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E72 "Do I still need anti-rabies shots if the dog that bit me is vaccinated?"

Rabies

Still go to an Animal Bite Treatment Center (ABTC) promptly after washing the wound. The health workers there will look at the bite and the dog's vaccination record and decide what treatment you need.

Don't skip the visit or wait for the dog to finish its 14-day observation first. DOH offices urge immediate consultation after any bite or scratch, because rabies is almost always fatal once symptoms appear.

Bring the dog's vaccination card or a photo of it if you can.

Source: DOH Bicol CHD, https://bicol.doh.gov.ph/news-releases/doh-bicol-chd-urges-immediate-treatment-after-animal-bites-scratches-responsible-pet-ownership-key-to-rabies-prevention/; WHO Rabies fact sheet, https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/rabies; IRR of RA 9482 (AO No. 01 s. 2008), Rule 5(e), https://dev.lawyerly.ph/laws/56761

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E73 "How is rabies spread?"

Rabies

Rabies spreads through the saliva of an infected animal, mostly through:

- Bites
- Scratches
- Saliva getting into open wounds, eyes, nose or mouth

Dogs cause up to 99% of human rabies cases worldwide, according to the WHO. In the Philippines, the DOH said 45% of rabies cases in 2024 came from the saliva of household pets.

Touching or feeding an animal, or a lick on unbroken skin, is not considered an exposure. Still, wash the area with soap and water.

Source: WHO Rabies fact sheet, https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/rabies; DOH data reported by Inquirer (15 March 2025), https://newsinfo.inquirer.net/2044154/rabies-cases-in-ph-almost-doubled-between-2020-and-2024

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E74 "Can rabies be cured?"

Rabies

Once symptoms show, rabies is almost always fatal, in both people and animals. That's why acting before symptoms appear is so important.

Rabies is fully preventable:

- After a bite or scratch, wash the wound well and get post-exposure prophylaxis at an Animal Bite Treatment Center right away
- Vaccinate your dogs and cats every year

In people, symptoms can appear about one week to one year after exposure, usually after 2 to 3 months. So don't wait to see if you feel sick.

Source: WHO Rabies fact sheet, https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/rabies; DOH Bicol CHD, https://bicol.doh.gov.ph/news-releases/doh-bicol-chd-urges-immediate-treatment-after-animal-bites-scratches-responsible-pet-ownership-key-to-rabies-prevention/; DOH data reported by Inquirer (15 March 2025), https://newsinfo.inquirer.net/2044154/rabies-cases-in-ph-almost-doubled-between-2020-and-2024

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E75 "What are the signs of rabies in a dog or cat?"

Rabies

The DOH lists these signs of rabies in animals:

- Change in behavior
- Aggressive behavior
- Excessive drooling
- Paralysis
- Fear of water

You can't confirm rabies just by looking at an animal; only a lab test can. If your pet shows these signs, keep away from its saliva, keep it confined, and call your vet or city or municipal veterinary office right away. If it bit or scratched anyone, they should go to an Animal Bite Treatment Center.

Source: DOH data reported by Inquirer (15 March 2025), https://newsinfo.inquirer.net/2044154/rabies-cases-in-ph-almost-doubled-between-2020-and-2024; IRR of RA 9482 (AO No. 01 s. 2008), Rule 9(2), https://dev.lawyerly.ph/laws/56761

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

E76 "Can cats get rabies too, or only dogs?"

Rabies

Cats can get rabies and pass it to people through bites and scratches. Rabies can infect all mammals.

The Anti-Rabies Act (RA 9482) mainly talks about dogs, but DOH offices urge owners to vaccinate both dogs and cats against rabies regularly and not let them roam freely. The national campaign theme is "Rabies-free na pusa't aso, kaligtasan ng pamilyang Pilipino."

Ask your vet about your cat's yearly anti-rabies shot, and treat any cat bite or scratch seriously.

Source: WHO Rabies fact sheet, https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/rabies; DOH Bicol CHD, https://bicol.doh.gov.ph/news-releases/doh-bicol-chd-urges-immediate-treatment-after-animal-bites-scratches-responsible-pet-ownership-key-to-rabies-prevention/; DOH Ilocos CHD, https://ro1.doh.gov.ph/doh-ilocos-pushes-for-community-action-to-stop-the-spread-of-rabies-in-pangasinan/

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E77 "Is anti-rabies treatment for people free?"

Rabies

Under Section 6 of RA 9482, the DOH must provide post-exposure treatment for bite victims at minimum cost, and free pre-exposure shots for high-risk workers. Free routine shots are also given to schoolchildren aged 5 to 14 in high-risk areas (Section 4).

Costs can still differ between government and private Animal Bite Treatment Centers, so ask your local health center or ABTC. Never skip treatment because of cost. And if a dog bit you, its owner is required by law to pay your medical expenses (Section 5).

Source: Republic Act No. 9482, Sections 4, 5 and 6, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2007/ra_9482_2007.html

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E78 "Is it illegal to abandon my pet?"

Philippine rules

Yes. RA 10631, which amended the Animal Welfare Act, added a rule against abandoning animals.

- Leaving your pet, for good or even for a while, without a good reason and without arranging for its care counts as maltreatment
- If abandonment leads to the animal suffering or dying, the owner faces the maximum penalty

If you can no longer care for your pet, look for a new home or ask a rescue group or shelter for help instead of leaving it on the street.

Source: Republic Act No. 10631, Section 7 (new Section 7 of RA 8485), https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2013/ra_10631_2013.html

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E79 "What's the penalty for animal cruelty in the Philippines?"

Philippine rules

Section 9 of the Animal Welfare Act, as amended by RA 10631, sets penalties after conviction:

- Animal dies: 1 year, 6 months and 1 day to 2 years in prison, and/or a fine up to P100,000
- Animal survives but is severely injured and can't survive without human help: 1 year and 1 day to 1 year and 6 months, and/or up to P50,000
- Other cruelty or neglect: 6 months to 1 year, and/or up to P30,000

Penalties go up to 2 years and 1 day to 3 years and/or up to P250,000 if the offense involves a syndicate, a business, a public officer, or 3 or more animals.

Source: Republic Act No. 10631, Section 9 (formerly Section 8 of RA 8485), https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2013/ra_10631_2013.html

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E80 "Where can I report animal abuse or neglect?"

Philippine rules

Under the Animal Welfare Act as amended by RA 10631 (Section 10):

- The Philippine National Police (PNP), the NBI and other law enforcement agencies have animal welfare enforcement officers
- The Secretary of Agriculture can deputize trained volunteers and members of NGOs and community groups as enforcement officers
- These officers can rescue maltreated animals and arrest violators

LGUs are also required to enforce the anti-cruelty rules of RA 8485 (RA 9482, Section 7). You can report to the police, your LGU, or an animal welfare group. Take photos or videos and note the date and place to help your report.

Source: Republic Act No. 10631, Section 10, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2013/ra_10631_2013.html; Republic Act No. 9482, Section 7, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2007/ra_9482_2007.html

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E81 "Can a pet legally be put to sleep in the Philippines?"

Philippine rules

Only for reasons the Animal Welfare Act allows. Section 6 of RA 8485 permits killing a pet when, for example:

- A licensed vet certifies it has an incurable communicable disease
- A licensed vet certifies it is needed to end the animal's suffering
- It is needed to prevent immediate danger to human life or limb

It must be done humanely, using methods approved by the Committee on Animal Welfare. Electrocution of dogs is banned under RA 9482. Talk to your vet if you're facing this decision.

Source: Republic Act No. 8485, Section 6, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra1998/ra_8485_1998.html; Republic Act No. 10631, Section 6, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2013/ra_10631_2013.html; Republic Act No. 9482, Sections 7 and 11, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra2007/ra_9482_2007.html

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E82 "What papers do I need to bring my dog or cat to another island or province?"

Philippine rules

You need a local shipping permit from the Bureau of Animal Industry (BAI), applied for online at nvqsd.bai.gov.ph. Under the BAI Citizen's Charter, dogs and cats need:

- A veterinary health certificate from a licensed vet, showing rabies vaccine details (brand, batch/lot number, date given, next due date)
- A rabies vaccination certificate signed by the vet with their PRC number
- The pet should be about 3 to 4 months old or older
- The rabies shot should be at least 14 days and not more than 1 year old (annual boosters can ship right away)

The permit is free; processing takes up to 3 working days. Rules may change, so confirm with BAI before your trip.

Source: BAI NVQSD Citizen's Charter, Service 8 (Local Shipping Permit), https://www.bai.gov.ph/cc/citizens%20charter%20(nvqsd).pdf; BAI One-Time Local Shipping Permit guide, https://nvqsd.bai.gov.ph/Admin/ONE%20TIME%20LOCAL%20PDF.pdf

☐ OK ☐ Change ☐ Remove

Corrections:

E83 “Are there rules on how my pet should be transported, like by van or boat?”

Philippine rules

Yes. Section 4 of the Animal Welfare Act (RA 8485) sets rules for transporting animals:

- Carriers must provide clean, sanitary facilities for animals
- Animals must get food and water on trips longer than 12 hours, or when needed
- Overcrowding, cruel confinement and putting animals in vehicle trunks count as cruelty

A BAI permit is required to transport animals. For pets, apply for a BAI local shipping permit before your trip, and prepare a vet health certificate and rabies vaccination certificate.

Source: Republic Act No. 8485, Section 4, https://lawphil.net/statutes/repacts/ra1998/ra_8485_1998.html; BAI NVQSD Citizen's Charter, https://www.bai.gov.ph/cc/citizens%20charter%20(nvqsd).pdf

☐ **OK** ☐ **Change** ☐ **Remove**

Corrections:

Sign-off

I have reviewed the content in this pack (items A1–A19, B1–B29, C1–C2, D1–D40, E1–E83). Subject to the corrections I have marked, it is appropriate as general educational information for pet owners. It does not replace a veterinary examination.

☐ Approved with no changes ☐ Approved after the marked changes are made ☐ Not approved (see comments)

Signature _____ Date _____

Printed name _____ PRC license no. _____

GENERAL COMMENTS

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